SOCIAL ANTHROPOLOGY

UNIT – I

INTRODUCTION

It is important to know the development and scope of social anthropology as a subject. We know social anthropology today has many stages of development. The subject has not obtained today's form overnight. It has many theoretical debates since its emergence and till today all the matters of debate have not come to an end. So, it is very much important to the students of anthropology to understand these issues and also to know the history related to the subject.

The most common and basic definition of Anthropology is to say that Anthropology is the study of man across time and space. Anthropology deals with every aspect of human being. It not only studies human beings in present context but also studies human beings' journey through the path of evolution from Pleistocene period till today's globalised world and tries to trace the future path. Anthropology studies man irrespective of any geographical boundary. It studies human being as a whole and tries to study differences within it.

NATURE AND SCOPE OF SOCIAL ANTHROPOLOGY

Social anthropology aims to study human society. It is a holistic study necessarily and covers all parts related to human society. Culture comes naturally under this, as it is an integral part of human society. So, the basic aim of social anthropology is to study human being as a social animal. Thus, to fulfil its aim it explores, in a broad area, covering almost every aspect of human social life. The aim of modern social anthropology is just not to study human society but also to understand the complex issues of modern human life. As primitive people have been the focus of anthropological study, the problems faced by these people in the process of development in modern days become very important for the anthropologists to study. Anthropologists not only deal with the study of these problems but also try to find out a solution for this. Developmental anthropology and Action anthropology etc. are the specialised fields within social anthropology which deal with such problems. Therefore, we can say that the scope and aim of social anthropology go together; one influences the other. As much as the scope increases a new aim comes out of it.

Though we have subjective debate over the term social anthropology and cultural anthropology, sometimes we find interchangeable use of these two terms. People use the term socio-cultural anthropology to replace these two terms. But historically there is a debate over the ideology of these two terms and as a student of anthropology we need to know these issues.

Anthropology basically has two dominant schools of thought. One is British school of thought, and the other is American school of thought. British school of thought branches out Anthropology into three basic branches

1) Biological or physical anthropology.

2) Social anthropology.

3) Archaeology.

American school defines four branches of Anthropology:

1) Physical anthropology

2) Cultural anthropology.

3) Archaeology

4) Linguistic anthropology.

Different scholars like S.C. Roy, D.N. Majumdar, G.S. Ghurye, S.C. Dube, N.K. Bose, L.P. Vidyarthi and S. Sinha had tried to find out the genesis and development of Social Anthropology in India. S.C. Roy's paper Anthropological Research in India (1921) reflects upon the works on tribes and castes published before 1921. The anthropological accounts consisted of the writings of British administrators and missionaries as before 1921 anthropological work in India was mainly done by these people. After this, D.N. Majumdar tried to trace the development of Anthropology in India. This attempt was made after twenty-five years of S.C. Roy's work. D.N. Majumdar tried to relate the developing discipline of Anthropology in India with the theory of culture that originated in Britain and America. American influence was first recognised besides the works of British administrators and missionaries.

ANTHROPOLOGICAL PERSPECTIVE

Anthropology is the study of people, past and present that focuses on understanding the human condition both culturally and biologically. Anthropological perspective focuses on the study of full scope of human diversity and application of that knowledge to help people of different backgrounds.

FOUR MAIN PERSPECTIVE

1. Cross-Cultural Approach

2. Evolutionary or Historical Approach

3. Ecological Approach

4. Holistic Approach

Cross-Cultural Approach

This emphasis also makes anthropology unique among the social sciences. Unlike sociologists, psychologists, economists and political scientists, anthropologists look beyond the confines of our own society and compare it to the beliefs and practices of other societies, past and present. Where a sociologist, for example, may attempt to explain social

organization with reference only to their own society, an anthropologist would almost invariably go on to compare our own patterns of social organization with other societies.

Evolutionary Or Historical Approach

This approach, coming from archaeology and physical anthropology, focuses upon both the biological and cultural evolution of human beings and of human societies. It is also one of the reasons why a four subfields approach is so important to the discipline. An evolutionary/historical approach is "diachronic." In other words, it is focused upon the understanding of and description of patterns of change over time. This approach provides time depth to an anthropological perspective which, along with its cross-cultural emphasis, helps to put contemporary society and contemporary patterns of social development into an historical context.

Ecological Approach

Focuses on human societies or cultures within the context of larger natural system. This approach is to understand the ecological perspective position of human being and its societies.

Holistic Approach

This approach focuses on philosophy of functionalism. It is very closely related to an ecological approach philosophically. In fact, anthropology was the first social science to begin to incorporate ecological insights into its studies of human behaviour and society. Ecology has been part of the discipline at least since the 1960s. Anthropology also remains the only social science which continues to incorporate ecology in a significant and integral way (even though all anthropologists wouldn’t agree that we should be ecological).

GROWTH AND DEVELOPENT OF INDIAN ANTHROPOLOGY

The course of development of anthropological thought and study in India slow but steady. The systematic efforts to unravel the secrets of humanity can be seen since the time of the Vedic literature of ancient India. Basu Roy describes the following phases of development of Indian Anthropology, while some other anthropologists differ in their opinion regarding the time span of these periods.

1) Formative Phase (1774 – 1919)

During this period the emphasis of anthropological studies was on tribal life and the diversity of their customs in India. Many encyclopaedias on tribes and castes were published. In addition to the ethnographic reports, revenue reports of Dalton, Buchanon and Lord Baden Powell also examined the social cultural situation in India during this period.

The foundation of Asiatic Society of India by Sir William Jones in 1774 was an important landmark during this period. This became the Asiatic Society of Bengal in 1784. By this time, the society also started publishing its journal regularly.

By 1872, ***The Indian Antiquary*** was published. It contained many articles of anthropological interests. In 1886, the Anthropological Society of Bombay published its journal. It was the first journal, exclusively for anthropology.

The publication of journals helped to disseminate anthropological outlook in India. In 1912 S C Roy published the monograph ***Munda and their country.*** The journal of Bihar and Orissa Research Society was started in 1915.

Anthropology had been introduced as subject in the Sociology Department of Bombay University in 1919. According to D N Majumdar, the formative phase ended in 1911. However, for L P Vidyarti, this period extended up to 1920.

2) The Constructive Phase (1920 – 1949)

L K Ananthakrishnan Iyer and R Chanda, the pioneers of Indian anthropology, joined the department during this phase. Another remarkable step during this period was the publication of journal 'Man in India' in 1921, under the editorial ship of S C Roy. The 25th Indian Science Congress was held at Calcutta in 1938, and the focal theme was 'Anthropology in India'. A joint session of the Indian Science Congress Association and British Association reviewed the progress of anthropology in India. This was the first review of the anthropological research in India. In 1939, Verrier Elwin published his book ***The Baiga.*** In this book he had proposed that the tribes should be left alone and they should be allowed to develop in isolation, away from the mainstream. The need for a full-fledged anthropological research organization was fulfilled by establishing **Anthropological Survey of India** in 1945. B S Guha was the first Director of this institution at Calcutta. In 1947, a Department of Anthropology was opened in the University of Delhi.

3) The Analytical Phase (1950 – 1990)

For D N Majumdar (1950), this phase began in 1938 and carried on to the present. The earlier anthropologists like Surjit Sinha, called this, the recent phase. By this time, Indian Anthropologists started regularly interacting with foreign anthropologists. Many kinds of collaborative works were taken up. Moreover, during this period, there was shift from the descriptive studies of preliterate societies to the analytical studies of complex societies.

Some anthropologists from abroad came to India to conduct research. Their works created a momentum to the anthropological research in India. The villages they studied became famous. Many village study monographs were published in the 1960s through the Census of India 1961. The first of these was a study of Ghaghara by L P Vidyarthi. These studies helped to generate new concepts and ideas. The works of L P Vidyarthi, B K Roy, Burman, R M Makhan Jha, P K Misra, K S Singh and T N Madan are worth mentioning.

4) Evaluative Phase (1990 to the present)

During recent times new areas of Anthropology and different sub-fields within these areas have been emergence. Interest in Medical Anthropology, Religion, Development studies and psychological studies are more evident. Numerous papers have been published by anthropologists in India concerning

(a) change leading to tribal identity, integration, vanishing culture and planning, (b) emergence of Industrial Anthropology,

(c) increased emphasis on tribal demography

(d) Integrated study of tribal regions.

Important contributions have been made to Action Research, Socio- Psychological Research, and Folk-lore researchers. Studies of Power structure and Leadership and Anthropology of Religion.

To conclude in the words of L P Vidyarthi. "The journey of Indian Anthropology still Continues". It has gone much ahead under the influence of and in collaboration with the British and American anthropologists. Of course, in a broader perspective, they will continue to influence the Indian social science for some more time. Anthropology originated a little late. But today it has become an important discipline all over the world. This subject taught in almost all renowned universities with greater importance. In some western countries, apart from anthropological institutions, anthropologists are appointed in various other areas as well. Thus, anthropology occupies a significant position and holds a great relevance in the modern world.

Features of Tribes and Concept of Tribe–Caste Continuum in India

India is a country of enormous **social and cultural diversity**. Along with caste, class, religion and language groups, **tribal communities** form an important part of Indian society. Tribes have their own traditions, customs, social institutions, languages, occupations and cultural practices. The study of tribes is important for understanding **social diversity, inclusion, development, empowerment and social change** in India.

CONCEPT OF TRIBE

The word **tribe** generally refers to a social group whose members share a common territory, culture, traditions, language, customs and a sense of collective identity.

In the Indian context, tribal communities are officially recognised as **Scheduled Tribes (STs)** under the Constitution.

A tribe traditionally tends to have:

- A common geographical area
- Common culture and traditions
- A shared language or dialect
- Strong community feeling
- Distinct social customs
- Traditional occupations
- A sense of common identity

Simple Example

Imagine a community living in a forest or hilly region for generations. Most members follow similar customs, celebrate common festivals, speak a local dialect and have traditional systems for resolving disputes. Such characteristics help us understand the traditional concept of a **tribal community**.

Major Features of Tribes

- **Common Territory:** Traditionally, tribal communities have been closely associated with a particular geographical area. They may inhabit forest regions, hills, mountains, Plateaus and Remote rural areas. **Example:** Many tribal communities in central India have historically depended upon forests for food, fuel, medicine and livelihood.
- **Common Culture:** Tribal communities generally possess distinctive cultural practices. These may include traditional dress, food habits, folk songs, folk dances, festivals, rituals, marriage customs, religious practices and Art and crafts. **Example:** The **Gond** and **Warli** communities are well known for distinctive artistic traditions.
- **Common Language or Dialect:** Many tribal communities have their own languages or dialects. Language plays an important role in maintaining cultural identity, oral traditions, folk knowledge, stories and myths and community relationships. However, many tribal people are also multilingual and use regional languages for education, employment and interaction with non-tribal populations.
- **Strong Sense of Community:** A strong feeling of **collective identity** is traditionally associated with tribal societies. Members often cooperate in agriculture, festivals, community activities, social ceremonies, conflict resolution and resource management
- **Tribal Religion and Beliefs:** Traditional tribal belief systems often include strong connections with nature, ancestors, spirits, mountains, rivers, forests and animals.
- **Distinctive Art and Cultural Expressions:** Tribal communities have contributed significantly to India's cultural heritage. Examples include Tribal paintings, Jewellery Woodcraft, Bamboo craft, pottery, folk music and dance.

UNIT-I

LONG QUESTIONS

1. Define Social Anthropology and discuss its nature, scope and major areas of study. Explain the importance of the holistic and comparative approaches in understanding human society.

2. Discuss the relationship between Social Anthropology and Sociology. Explain their similarities, differences, approaches and areas of overlap with suitable examples.

3. Explain the major anthropological perspectives used in the study of human society. Discuss the cross-cultural, evolutionary/historical, ecological and holistic approaches in detail.

4. Define the concept of tribe and discuss the major characteristics of tribal communities. Explain the importance of common territory, culture, language, community feeling, customs and traditional occupations in tribal life.

5. Discuss the growth and development of Social Anthropology in India. Explain the major phases of Indian Anthropology and highlight the contributions of important Indian anthropologists.

6. Explain the concept of Tribe–Caste Continuum in India. Discuss how tribal and caste communities may show similarities, differences and processes of social interaction and cultural change.

UNIT-2

Introduction – What is Social Anthropology?

Meaning

The word anthropology comes from two Greek words: anthropos (human being) and logos (study or science). So, anthropology means "the study of human beings". It studies humans in the widest possible way – their bodies, their past, their languages and their ways of life.

Social Anthropology is the branch that studies human society and culture: how people live together, form families, earn a living, exchange goods, follow religion, obey rules and organise power. Instead of asking "how does one person behave?", it asks, "how do groups of people behave, and why do they behave in these ways?".

Main branches of Anthropology

Branch	What it studies	Simple example
Physical (Biological) Anthropology	**Human evolution, body types, genetics**	**Why do people differ in skin colour or height?**
Archaeological Anthropology	**Past societies through tools, ruins and remains**	**Life in the Indus Valley from excavated objects**
Linguistic Anthropology	**Language and how it shapes thought**	**How do tribal languages describe kinship?**
Social / Cultural Anthropology	**Living societies, customs, institutions**	**Marriage rules among the Santhals; trade among Trobriand islanders**

Social anthropology and cultural anthropology are remarkably close. In Britain the term social anthropology is preferred (focus on social relations and structure). In the USA the term cultural anthropology is preferred (focus on beliefs, values and symbols). In these notes we treat them together.

Important characteristics

- Holistic approach: it studies a society as a whole – economy, religion, family, politics – because all parts are linked.
- Comparative method: it compares many societies to find common patterns and real differences.
- Fieldwork: the anthropologist lives among the people, learns their language and observes daily life (this is called participant observation).
- Cultural relativism: every culture should be understood in its own terms, not judged as "good" or "bad" by our standards.

- Emic and etic views: the emic view is the "insider's" understanding; the etic view is the "outsider's" scientific description.

Origin of Social Anthropology

Early roots

Curiosity about "other people" is very old. Ancient Greek writers such as Herodotus (often called the "Father of History") described the customs of Egyptians, Persians and Scythians. Chinese, Arab and Indian travellers also left accounts. Ibn Khaldun (14th century) wrote about how societies rise and fall, and Al-Biruni wrote a famous study of India in the 11th century. But these were travel accounts, not organised science**.**

Why did anthropology begin as a science in the 19th century?

1. Age of exploration and colonial expansion: European traders, missionaries and administrators met people in Africa, Asia, the Americas and the Pacific whose ways of life looked very different. Europeans wanted to understand them – partly out of curiosity, partly to govern and trade with them.
2. Darwin's theory of evolution (1859): *On the Origin of Species* changed how people thought about living things. Scholars began asking whether human societies also "evolve" step by step.
3. The Enlightenment and belief in reason: thinkers believed society could be studied scientifically, like nature.
4. Growth of other social sciences: sociology (Comte, Spencer, Durkheim), history and economics gave methods and ideas.
5. Museums and collections: objects, tools and photographs brought from colonies created material to study.

Three stages in the growth of the subject

- Stage 1 – Speculative or "armchair" stage (c. 1850–1900): scholars sat in libraries and built grand theories from reports of travellers and missionaries. Evolutionism and Diffusionism belong here.
- Stage 2 – Fieldwork stage (c. 1900–1950): anthropologists went to live among the people. Functionalism dominated. Emphasis on detail and direct observation.
- Stage 3 – Theoretical diversification (c. 1950 onwards): Structuralism, symbolic anthropology, Marxist and feminist approaches, and interpretive anthropology appeared.

Meaning of Evolutionism

Evolutionism (also called Classical Evolutionism or Unilineal Evolutionism) is the theory that all human societies pass through the same series of stages in the same order – from simple to complex, from "primitive" to "civilised". It was the first major theory of social anthropology and dominated the second half of the 19th century.

Think of the growth of a human being: infant → child → adult. Evolutionists believed societies also grow in a fixed sequence. Just as every person passes through childhood, every society was thought to pass through early stages of hunting, herding, farming and finally industrial civilisation.

Basic ideas (assumptions)

- Psychic unity of mankind: the human mind works in basically the same way everywhere. So, people in different places, facing similar problems, invent similar solutions independently.
- Unilineal (single line) development: there is one main path of progress that all societies follow.
- Progress: societies move from simple to complex, from lower to higher forms.
- Comparative method: by placing present-day "simple" societies on the ladder of stages, we can reconstruct the past of "advanced" societies. Today's tribes were seen as "living fossils".
- Survivals: customs that continue after their original meaning is lost (for example, throwing rice or shoes at a wedding) prove earlier stages.

Major evolutionist thinkers

(a) Herbert Spencer (1820–1903)

An English philosopher who applied evolution to society before Darwin's book. He compared society to a living organism that grows from simple to complex and coined the phrase "survival of the fittest". His ideas are sometimes called Social Darwinism. He believed societies develop from military (fighting) types to industrial (trading) types. Main work: *The Principles of Sociology* (1876–96).

(b) Lewis Henry Morgan (1818–1881)

An American lawyer and anthropologist who studied the Iroquois Indians and wrote about kinship. In *Ancient Society* (1877) he divided human history into three big periods, each with sub-stages, based mainly on technology and subsistence (how people get food).

Stage	Sub-stage	Key achievement
SAVAGERY	**Lower**	**Fruit and nut gathering; beginning of speech**

Stage	Sub-stage	Key achievement
	Middle	**Fish food and use of fire**
	Upper	**Invention of the bow and arrow**
BARBARISM	**Lower**	**Invention of pottery**
	Middle	**Domestication of animals (Old World) / irrigated farming (New World)**
	Upper	**Smelting of iron; iron tools**
CIVILISATION	**–**	**Invention of the phonetic alphabet and writing; later, the state and private property**

Morgan also traced the growth of the family and of property. He believed early society had no fixed marriage and that the family changed step by step towards the modern monogamous family. Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels admired Morgan and used his ideas in *The Origin of the Family, Private Property and the State* (1884).

(c) Edward Burnett Tylor (1832–1917)

An English scholar, called the "Father of Cultural Anthropology". In *Primitive Culture* (1871) he gave the famous definition:

Tylor proposed that religion began with animism – the belief in spirits or souls in living beings and natural objects (trees, rivers, mountains). From animism grew belief in gods and later organised religion. He also stressed the idea of survivals and the use of the comparative method.

(d) Sir James George Frazer (1854–1941)

A Scottish scholar who wrote the huge work *The Golden Bough* (1890, expanded later). He suggested that human thought evolved in three stages:

Stage	Belief	Example
1. Magic	People believe they can control nature by rituals that follow "laws" (like produces like; things once in contact stay connected)	Rain-making dances; harming a doll to harm an enemy
2. Religion	When magic fails, people turn to gods and pray for help	Worship, offerings and prayer for rain

Stage	Belief	Example
3. Science	Humans finally understand natural causes and use them	Weather forecasting, irrigation technology

(e) Other early evolutionists

- J. J. Bachofen (*Mother Right*, 1861): believed early society was ruled by women (matriarchy) before it became patriarchal.
- J. F. McLennan (*Primitive Marriage*, 1865): wrote on marriage by capture and early forms of marriage.
- Sir Henry Maine (*Ancient Law*, 1861): described a movement in law from "status to contract" – from rights fixed by birth and family to rights created by free agreements. (This idea is important for commerce students: modern business is based on contracts!)

A simple picture of the evolutionist ladder

Level	Way of life	Family / Marriage	Religion (Tylor / Frazer)
Early	Hunting and food gathering	Promiscuity, group marriage (assumed)	Magic, animism
Middle	Herding, simple farming	Matriarchy / patriarchy, polygamy	Polytheism (many gods)
Advanced	Iron tools, writing, cities, trade	Monogamy, private property	Monotheism, then science

Contributions of Evolutionism

- Made the study of human society systematic and scientific.
- Introduced the ideas of culture, kinship systems and the comparative method.
- Showed that human institutions (family, religion, property, law) change over time.
- Encouraged collection of data about tribal societies from around the world.
- Fought the old belief that some races were separately created or permanently inferior; stressed the psychic unity of mankind.

Criticisms of Evolutionism

1. Armchair method: most evolutionists never did fieldwork. They relied on second-hand and sometimes unreliable reports.

2. Ethnocentrism: they placed European society at the top and called others "primitive" or "savage" – a biased judgement.
3. Speculation: stages such as universal "promiscuity" or "matriarchy" had little proof.
4. One-line path is false: societies do not all follow the same sequence. Some skip stages; some go backward; some develop in unique ways.
5. Living fossils is wrong: every present-day society has its own long history; tribal societies are not "the past frozen in time".
6. Neglect of history and diffusion: ignoring borrowing between societies (the point made by Diffusionists).
7. Racist misuse: Social Darwinism was used to justify colonial rule and inequality.

Neo-Evolutionism (a later revival)

In the 20th century, scholars such as Leslie White, Julian Steward and Marshall Sahlins revived evolutionary ideas in a more careful form. White linked cultural progress to energy use per person; Steward proposed multilinear evolution (many paths, not just one) and stressed adaptation to environment. These are called neo-evolutionists.

Diffusionism

Meaning of Diffusionism

Diffusion means "spreading". Diffusionism is the theory that cultural traits (tools, ideas, customs, technologies) are invented in only one or a few places and then spread to other societies through contact, migration, trade and conquest. So the similarities we see between distant societies are mainly due to borrowing, not independent invention.

Example: the spread of papermaking from China to the Arab world and then to Europe; the spread of tea, cotton, printing, the numerals 0–9 and the idea of zero from Asia to other parts of the world; the spread of mobile phones and UPI-like payment ideas in the modern age.

Evolutionism vs Diffusionism – the core difference

Point	Evolutionism	Diffusionism
Cause of similarity	Independent invention because of the same human mind	Borrowing and spread from a centre
Change comes from	Internal growth in stages	External contact between societies
Path	One common path (unilineal)	Many paths depending on contacts
Main focus	Stages, time, sequence	Geography, migration, culture areas
Attitude to invention	Invention is common and repeated	Invention is rare; borrowing is common

Merits (strengths) of Diffusionism

- Correctly showed that contact and borrowing are major causes of cultural change – no society develops in isolation.
- Gave importance to history, geography and migration.
- Helped culture area studies and museum classification.
- Encouraged the careful use of evidence (criteria of form and quantity).
- Corrected the one-line picture of Evolutionism by showing many routes of development.

Criticisms of Diffusionism

1. Extreme claims: believing one place (Egypt) was the source of all civilisations is unscientific and belittles other peoples.
2. Ignores independent invention: similar things can arise separately (for example, the pyramids of Egypt and Mexico were built for distinct reasons at different times).
3. Cannot explain why a trait is accepted or rejected – it only says, "it spread".
4. Lack of written history: for non-literate societies, the routes of spread are guessed, not proved.

5. Neglects internal factors: how a society changes a borrowed trait to suit itself (called reinterpretation or acculturation). Treats culture as a heap of traits rather than a system of connected parts.

Functionalism

Meaning

Functionalism is the theory that every custom, belief and institution in a society has a function – a job it performs – that helps satisfy human needs or keeps society running smoothly. To understand any social practice, we must ask: what purpose does it serve and how is it connected to the rest of society?

An easy comparison is the human body: the heart pumps blood, the lungs give oxygen, the kidneys clean the blood. Each organ has a function, and the body survives because they work together. In the same way, family, economy, religion, law and education are like "organs" of society.

Two branches of Functionalism

	Malinowski – Psychological (Biological) Functionalism	Radcliffe-Brown – Structural Functionalism
Key idea	Culture exists to satisfy the needs of individuals	Institutions exist to maintain the social structure
Focus	Individual needs: food, safety, reproduction, etc.	Society and relations between people
Debt to	Psychology and biology	Durkheim and sociology
Method	Long intensive fieldwork, close details	Comparison to find general laws of society

Malinowski's theory of needs

Malinowski said culture is a system of institutions developed to satisfy human needs. He listed basic (biological) needs and matching cultural responses:

Basic need	Cultural response (institution)
Nutrition (food)	Commissariat – food production, farming, cooking, trade
Reproduction	Kinship, marriage, family
Bodily comforts	Shelter, clothing, housing
Safety	Protection, law, defence

Basic need	Cultural response (institution)
Movement	Activities, transport, travel
Growth	Training, education
Health	Hygiene, medicine, healing

Merits of Functionalism

- Established intensive fieldwork as the core method.
- Studied societies as wholes, showing the links between economy, religion, kinship and politics.
- Replaced speculative history with observable facts.
- Treated so-called "primitive" societies as rational and orderly, not backward.
- Its ideas are useful to understand organisations (each department has a function) and institutions.

Criticisms of Functionalism

1. Static: it explains stability but not social change, conflict, or history.
2. Overemphasis on harmony treats society as always balanced; ignores inequality, exploitation and power struggle (Marxist criticism).
3. Teleological reasoning: says a custom exists "because" it serves a function – but a custom may have a function without being the reason it started.
4. Difficult to test: any custom can be given some function by clever argument.
5. Ignores the individual and meaning especially in Radcliffe-Brown, who treated people as parts of a system.
6. Ignores colonial context: fieldwork was done within colonial rule, whose impact was often ignored.
7. Evaluation problem: it fails to explain harmful (dysfunctional) customs.

Structuralism – Claude Lévi-Strauss

Meaning of Structuralism

Structuralism is the approach that looks for deep, hidden structures underlying the visible surface of culture. It holds that the many customs, myths, kinship rules and rituals we observe are like the "surface" of an iceberg; the real pattern lies below, in the way the human mind organises the world.

Think of the grammar of a language. People speak fluently without knowing grammar rules, yet the rules shape every sentence. Structuralists believe that culture works like a language: it has an unseen "grammar" that we can discover.

Claude Lévi-Strauss (1908–2009): life in brief

Born in Brussels (Belgium) to French parents, he studied law and philosophy in Paris. In 1935 he went to Brazil as a professor in São Paulo and did fieldwork among Amazonian peoples (Bororo, Nambikwara, Caduveo). During the Second World War he lived in New York, where he met Roman Jakobson, a linguist, and Franz Boas. He later held a chair in Social Anthropology at the Collège de France (from 1959) and became one of the most famous intellectuals of the 20th century. He lived to the age of 100.

Major works

Work	Year	Subject
The Elementary Structures of Kinship	1949	Marriage rules, incest taboo, exchange
Tristes Tropiques	1955	Travel memoir and reflections on anthropology
Structural Anthropology	1958	Collection of essays on method
Totemism; The Savage Mind (La Pensée Sauvage)	1962	Classification, "primitive" thought
Mythologiques (4 volumes, incl. The Raw and the Cooked)	1964–71	Analysis of South and North American myths

Sources of his ideas

- Structural linguistics – Ferdinand de Saussure and Roman Jakobson: language is a system of signs and contrasts. The meaning of a word depends on its difference from other words (for example "day" has meaning through contrast with "night"). Sounds (phonemes) are the basic units.

- Marcel Mauss: the idea of reciprocal exchange (*The Gift*).
- Durkheim: society as a reality made up of collective representations.
- Marx and Freud (in his own words): he admired both for looking for hidden realities below the surface.
- Boas: careful respect for the unique detail of each culture.

Siegfried Frederick Nadel (S. F. Nadel)

Life and work

S. F. Nadel (1903–1956) was born in Vienna, Austria. He first studied psychology, philosophy and music, then turned to anthropology under C. G. Seligman and Malinowski in London. Because of his training in logic and philosophy, he was known for clear, careful thought and precise definitions. He did fieldwork in Nigeria (among the Nupe) and in the Nuba Hills of Sudan, and served as an anthropologist under British colonial administration in Africa. Later he became Professor of Anthropology at the Australian National University (Canberra) and died at a young age**.**

Major works

Work	Year	Subject
A Black Byzantium: The Kingdom of Nupe in Nigeria	1942	Political, economic and social life of the Nupe state
The Nuba: An Anthropological Study of the Hill Tribes of Kordofan	1947	Tribal societies of Sudan
The Foundations of Social Anthropology	1951	Methods and logic of the subject
Nupe Religion	1954	Religious life of the Nupe
Witchcraft in Four African Societies	1952 (article)	Comparative study of witchcraft beliefs
The Theory of Social Structure	1957 (posthumous)	His important theory of structure and role

UNIT-II

LONG QUESTIONS

1. Discuss the origin and development of Social Anthropology as a discipline. Explain the major intellectual and historical factors responsible for its emergence as a scientific study of human society.
2. What is Evolutionism? Discuss the major assumptions and contributions of classical evolutionists such as Herbert Spencer, Lewis Henry Morgan, E. B. Tylor and James Frazer. Also examine the major criticisms of Evolutionism.
3. Explain the theory of Diffusionism in Social Anthropology. Discuss its major assumptions, contributions and limitations. How does Diffusionism differ from Evolutionism?
4. What is Functionalism? Explain the functionalist approach with special reference to Bronislaw Malinowski and A. R. Radcliffe-Brown. Discuss the major contributions and criticisms of Functionalism.
5. Explain the Structuralist approach in Social Anthropology with special reference to Claude Lévi-Strauss. Discuss his understanding of culture, myths, kinship and the underlying structures of human thought.

UNIT – III

Kinship

Introduction

Kinship and religion are two of the most important institutions for understanding primitive and traditional societies. In societies where modern institutions such as formal government, courts, police, schools and welfare organizations were either absent or less developed, people depended heavily on family, kinship, customs, religion and traditional practices to organize their social life. Kinship provided the basic structure through which people established relationships, received protection, inherited property, regulated marriage and participated in economic activities. Religion provided beliefs, rituals and moral rules that helped people understand the natural and social world around them. Magic was also closely associated with religion and was often used to deal with uncertainty, danger and events that people could not explain through ordinary knowledge.

Meaning of Kinship

Kinship refers to the socially recognized relationships that exist between people on the basis of blood relationships, descent and marriage. In simple terms, kinship is a system of social relationships through which individuals are connected to one another as members of a family, lineage, clan or wider community. Relationships between parents and children, brothers and sisters, grandparents and grandchildren are examples of relationships based on descent or biological connection. Relationships such as husband and wife, father-in-law and daughter-in-law, mother-in-law and son-in-law are established through marriage. However, kinship is not simply a biological relationship. Society gives these relationships particular rights, duties, responsibilities and expectations. For example, a father is not merely biologically related to his child but is also expected to provide care, protection and guidance. Similarly, relatives are often expected to help one another during marriage, illness, death and other important occasions.

Kinship was particularly important in primitive societies because the individual was strongly connected with the family and wider kin group. A person's identity, social position, responsibilities and even economic opportunities were often determined by their membership in a particular family, lineage or clan. Instead of depending mainly on formal institutions, individuals often depended upon their relatives for protection, economic assistance and social security. Thus, kinship can be understood as one of the fundamental principles through which primitive societies were organized.

Importance of Kinship in Primitive Societies

Kinship played a very important role in the organization of primitive societies. It provided the basic framework for social organization by bringing individuals together into families, lineages, clans and tribes. In many traditional societies, an individual was not viewed as an isolated person but as a member of a particular kin group. The behaviour of one individual

could affect the reputation and position of the entire family or clan. Therefore, kinship created a strong sense of belonging and collective identity.

Kinship also played an important role in providing economic cooperation. Members of a kin group often worked together in activities such as hunting, fishing, agriculture, gathering food and constructing houses. When one member faced economic difficulty, other relatives could provide assistance. In this way, kinship acted as an informal system of economic security. The sharing of food, labour and other resources helped the community survive, particularly in situations where resources were uncertain.

Kinship was also connected with political organization. In many traditional societies, leadership was associated with particular families, lineages or clans. Elders and influential members of kin groups could exercise authority and participate in decision-making. In some communities, disputes were settled through elders or representatives of the concerned families rather than through formal courts. Thus, kinship could provide a basis for political authority and conflict resolution.

Another important function of kinship was social control. Members of a family or clan were expected to follow established customs and traditions. A person who violated social norms could bring shame not only upon themselves but also upon their family. The fear of losing social respect and the desire to maintain family honour encouraged individuals to follow accepted rules. Kinship therefore helped maintain discipline and social order.

Kinship was also important in regulating marriage. Societies generally have rules concerning whom a person can marry and whom they cannot marry. Restrictions on marriage between close relatives are commonly found in human societies. At the same time, certain kinship systems encourage marriage between particular groups. Marriage therefore does not merely unite two individuals; it can also create relationships between two families, lineages or communities.

Inheritance is another important area connected with kinship. Property, land, livestock, family possessions and social positions may be transferred according to rules of descent. In a patrilineal system, inheritance may traditionally pass through the male line, whereas in a matrilineal system descent and certain forms of inheritance are associated with the maternal line. Thus, kinship determines not only personal relationships but also access to material resources.

Kinship also performs an important emotional and psychological function. Relatives provide companionship, affection, care and support during difficult situations. During events such as birth, marriage, illness and death, relatives come together and provide practical and emotional assistance. In this sense, kinship provides a feeling of security and belonging.

Types of Kinship

The family is generally regarded as the most basic kinship group. It consists of individuals connected through marriage, descent, adoption or socially recognized relationships. The

family performs important functions such as reproduction, socialization, economic cooperation, protection and emotional support. In primitive societies, the family was often closely connected with wider kinship groups.

A lineage is a kinship group whose members believe that they can trace their descent from a known common ancestor. Members of a lineage may share property, participate in common rituals and cooperate in economic and social activities. A clan is generally a larger kinship group whose members claim descent from a common ancestor, although the exact genealogical connection may not always be known. In some societies, the common ancestor of a clan may be represented by an animal, plant or natural object. This relationship is sometimes connected with the concept of totemism.

A phratry refers to a larger social group consisting of several related clans. A moiety refers to a division of a society into two major social groups. Each group may have its own rules, rituals and responsibilities. These forms of kinship organization demonstrate that traditional societies could have complex systems of social organization even when they did not have modern political institutions.

Affinal Kinship: Affinal kinship is the term used to describe the relationship between two people who are married. When a person marries, he forms a bond with not only the girl he marries, but also several other members of her family. Furthermore, not only the person marrying is tied to the girl's family, but so are his family members. As a result, when a couple marries, a slew of new relationships is born. A person becomes not only a husband after marriage, but also a brother in- law and a son-in-law. It's worth noting that several marriage-related relationships are referred to by the same term in the English language. Sala, jija, and other in-laws are all referred to as "brother-in-law." A person's name changes to foofa, nandoi, and mausa after they marry. Similarly, when a girl marries, she not only becomes a wife but also a daughter-in-law; she is known as chichi, bhabhi, devrani, jethani, mami, and so on. As a result, marriage gives rise to a slew of affinal kin relationships.

Consanguineous Kinship: Consanguineous kinship refers to the relationship between people who are related by blood. Consanguineous kin are blood relatives, whereas affinal kin are married relatives.

Consanguineous kinship describes the relationship between parents and their children, as well as siblings. Consanguineous kinship is kinship between brothers and sisters. Children of the same parents are known as siblings. Sons, brothers, sisters, uncles, elder uncles, nephews, and cousins are all consanguineous relatives. i.e. they're blood relatives. It should be noted that a blood relationship can be both real and imagined in this context. The father of a child is unknown among polyandrous tribes. A biologically produced child is treated as if it were one's own. As a result, blood relations can be established not only biologically, but also socially.

Family

The family is the fundamental unit of all human societies, regardless of its nature. The family is the foundation of all human societies, whether primitive or modern. It can be found in some form or another in all cultures and groups.

Family is a group of persons united by the ties of marriage, blood, or adoption, consisting of a single household, interacting and intercommunicating with each other in their respective roles of husband and wife, mother and father, son and daughter, brother and sister, and creating and maintaining a common culture.

Functions of Family

A family is a functional unit among tribes, as it is in any society. It serves certain functions for both its members and society. Family functions can be divided into two categories: **Basic and Traditional**.

a) Basic Functions

i. Biological Functions: Include sexual needs fulfilment, reproduction, and so on. These are regarded as critical functions.

ii. Psychological Functions: Include child protection and rearing, wife safety and security, and so on. Family is not only a place of birth but also a place of protection and care for children.

b) Traditional Functions

i. Economic Functions: It includes meeting its members' economic needs such as food, clothing, and shelter. A member or members of the family arrange for the family's livelihood. They also create and maintain family property.

ii. Social Functions: These functions include child socialization for personality development and education. Members learn about their culture through socialization. The family shapes the behavior of its members based on culture. As a result, the family is an important agency for transmitting culture to the next generation.

iii. Religious and Cultural Functions: The family teaches its members about religion. The family teaches children about their customs, traditions, taboos, art, music, and dancing.

iv. Health Related Functions: The family is concerned about the health of its members. It also teaches them about the tribal system of medicine, which is primarily based on herbs. However, they believe in magic, witchcraft, sorcery, and other supernatural cures because they believe that evil spirits cause diseases.

v. Organizational Functions: The tribal family is the primary organizational unit in the village. Each family contributes money, labor, and personnel to the village's well-being.

Finally, it aids in efficiently utilizing the environment, which is required to satisfy man's more intimate needs, such as hunger.

Characteristics of Tribal Family

• A family is limited in size.

• The relationship between family members is permanent.

• Husband and wife are inseparable sexual partners.

• At least one family member must be the breadwinner for all members. • Members live in the same house.

• Members use the same nomenclature.

• The family is the primary source of education for children.

Classification of the Family

Based on Marriage

i. Monogamous Family: A monogamous family consists of one husband and one wife. The monogamous family system is a very common type of family among the tribes.

ii. Polygynous Family: A polygynous family is one in which a man marries more than one wife. Polygynous families are common throughout tribal India. This type of family can be found among the Nagas and Gonds, as well as in Odisha's tribes.

iii. Polyandrous Family: It is made up of one woman and several husbands. Two types of polyandrous families are

(i) Fraternal polyandry

(ii) Non-Fraternal polyandry.

In fraternal polyandry, a woman's husbands are brothers. The Khasis practice this type of family. In non-fraternal polyandry, a woman's husbands are not related to each other.

Based on Structure

i. Nuclear Family: It is made up of both the couple and their unmarried children. These families include the Khasi, Juang, Santhal, and Bhuinya.

ii. A joint family comprises closely related relatives or two or more nuclear families. It could be either matrilocal or patrilocal. This type of family can be found among several Indian tribes.

iii. Extended Family: The extended family is formed when the addition of closely related kin expands the nuclear family. It comprises aunts, grandparents, grandchildren, and so on. As a result, an extended family is very large. These families are common among the Santhal, Ho. Juang, and others.

Based on Residence

i. Patrilocal Family: When a couple moves to live with the husband's family after marriage, the family is known as a patrilocal family. The patrilocal family system is a common type of family among the Oraon, Ho, and Kharia tribes.

ii. Matrilocal Family: After marriage, the husband moves into the wife's home and lives there. The Khasi, for example, have a matrilocal family.

Based on Authority

i. Patriarchal Family: The father wields absolute power in this type of family. Patriarchal families are common in the majority of Indian tribes.

ii. Matriarchal Family: A matriarchal family is one in which authority is held by the mother or any of the female members of the household. The Khasi tribe is one example.

iii. Avunculocal Family: When the sources of authority are neither father nor mother but uncle, it is called avaunculocal units.

Based on Ancestry and Property Inheritance

i. Patrilineal Family: A patrilineal family is one in which descent is traced through the father, and property inheritance occurs along the male line of descent. This type of family is found in a variety of tribes.

ii. Matrilineal Family: A matrilineal family is one in which descent is traced through the mother and females inherit property. Assam's Garo and Khasi families are two examples of this type of family.

Based on Blood Relationship

i. Consanguineous Family: A nucleus of blood relatives is surrounded by a fringe of spouses to form this type of family. In other words, the consanguineous family comprises primary families and blood relatives. It is made up of members who are related by blood. Marriage does not end in this type of family, and family membership continues even after marriage. This type of family can be found among the Khasis of Assam and Meghalaya.

ii. Conjugal Family: This type of family consists of a husband, wife, and their children, as well as their affinal kin. The conjugal bond is highlighted in this family. The conjugal family is found in the majority of Indian tribes. As an example, consider the Kharia family of Orissa and Chotanagpur.

Meaning of Religion

Religion is a system of beliefs, values, rituals and practices related to the sacred or supernatural. It attempts to provide explanations about important questions concerning human existence, life, death, nature, suffering and the unknown. Religion can involve belief in gods, spirits, ancestors or other supernatural powers. It can also involve sacred places, objects, symbols, ceremonies and moral rules.

Religion was particularly important in primitive societies because people often faced natural events that they could not explain scientifically. Thunder, lightning, drought, floods, disease, death, dreams and changes in seasons could create fear and uncertainty. Religious beliefs and

rituals provided explanations for such events and gave people a framework for understanding their environment.

Theories of the Origin of Religion

Sociologists and anthropologists have proposed different theories to explain the origin and development of religion. Two major approaches relevant to this topic are the evolutionary approach and the functional approach. The evolutionary approach attempts to understand how religious beliefs may have developed over time, while the functional approach focuses more on the functions performed by religion in society.

Evolutionary Theory of Religion

The evolutionary approach developed mainly during the nineteenth century. Scholars such as E.B. Tylor, James Frazer, Herbert Spencer and R.R. Marett attempted to explain religion as something that developed gradually as human beings tried to understand their environment and their own experiences.

E.B. Tylor considered animism to be an important early form of religion. According to Tylor, early human beings experienced dreams, death, sleep and visions and attempted to explain these experiences through the idea of the soul or spirit. For example, when a person dreamed about someone who was physically absent, early humans might have interpreted this as evidence that the person's spirit could exist separately from the physical body. From this kind of reasoning, beliefs in souls and spirits could develop. Tylor therefore associated early religious thought with the belief that supernatural spirits existed in humans, animals and aspects of nature.

James Frazer proposed an evolutionary sequence involving magic, religion and science. In his classical formulation, human beings initially attempted to control nature through magic. When magical practices were considered insufficient, people increasingly turned towards supernatural beings through religion. With the development of observation, experimentation and rational knowledge, science eventually developed as another means of understanding nature. This idea can be summarized as **Magic → Religion → Science**. Contemporary anthropology does not generally accept this as a universal sequence through which every society necessarily passes, but Frazer's theory remains historically important in the study of anthropology and religion.

Herbert Spencer emphasized ancestor worship in explaining the development of religion. According to this approach, experiences involving death, dreams and memories of deceased relatives could encourage people to believe that the dead continued to exist in spiritual form. These spirits could then be regarded as capable of influencing the living. Religious practices could consequently develop around the remembrance and worship of ancestors.

R.R. Marett proposed the concept of animatism to describe belief in an impersonal supernatural power. According to this idea, early people might believe that certain objects, places or individuals possessed special supernatural power. Such beliefs demonstrate that religion does not necessarily begin with clearly defined gods or spirits but can also involve more general ideas about supernatural power.

Functional Theory of Religion

The functional approach does not primarily ask how religion originated. Instead, it asks what religion does for individuals and society. Important scholars associated with this approach include Émile Durkheim, Bronislaw Malinowski and A.R. Radcliffe-Brown.

Émile Durkheim studied religion as a social institution. In his work *The Elementary Forms of Religious Life*, he examined religious life among Australian Aboriginal communities as represented in the ethnographic material available to him. Durkheim argued that religion creates social solidarity by bringing people together around shared beliefs, symbols and rituals. He distinguished between the sacred and the profane. The sacred refers to things that are considered special, holy or set apart, while the profane refers to ordinary everyday activities and objects.

According to Durkheim, religious rituals bring people together and create a sense of collective belonging. During collective ceremonies, people may experience intense emotional energy and a feeling of being part of something larger than themselves. Durkheim described this experience as **collective effervescence**. Religious symbols can therefore become symbols of the community itself and strengthen social solidarity.

Bronislaw Malinowski emphasized the role of religion and magic in dealing with uncertainty and psychological stress. According to Malinowski, human beings may have technical knowledge for dealing with ordinary situations, but uncertainty remains in activities involving danger and unpredictable outcomes. For example, a fisherman may possess considerable knowledge about fishing but may still perform rituals before entering dangerous waters. Such rituals can provide confidence, courage and emotional security.

A.R. Radcliffe-Brown emphasized the relationship between religion, ritual and social structure. According to this approach, religious rituals can strengthen social relationships and reinforce shared values. Rituals help individuals recognize their obligations towards one another and contribute to the maintenance of social order.

Marriage

Marriage is a social institution and marriage and family are complementary concepts. As such marriage is found in almost all societies. Without marriage one cannot think of a family. “Marriage is, “a set of cultural patterns to sanction parenthood and to provide a stable background for the care and rearing of children.”

The Tribal Marriages can be classified into the following types:

1. Monogamy: In this type of marriage one man married to one woman or one woman marries one man. The husband and wife may or may not be (usually not) related to each other before marriage, most of the Indian tribes practice monogamy.

2. Polygamy:

It is the marriage of one person with more than one person of the opposite sex. **It has two subtypes:**

(a) Polygyny.

(b) Polyandry.

(a) Polygyny:

In this type of marriage one man marries several women. The husband and wives may or may not be related to each other before marriage. Wives may be related among themselves. When the wives are related to each other as sisters it is called sororal polygyny. If they are not related as sisters, it is called non-sororal polygyny. Polygyny is found among the Naga tribes, the Gond, the Baiga and the Toda. It is also found among the Lushai, Juang and the Kondh.

Polygyny is practiced among the tribals due to several reasons. First of all, it is practiced due to the imbalance of the sex ratio, where women outnumber men. The second reason is that the practice of polygyny accords higher status and prestige. This is the reason why the tribal chiefs keep many wives. Thirdly the tribals like the Lushai or the Gonds practice polygyny. So that a number of wives and their children will provide the husband with free and reliable labor.

Merits of Polygyny:

Polygyny has the following merits:

(i) It facilitates better division of labor in the family.

(ii) It ensures the adequate sexual satisfaction of the husband.

(iii) It reproduces a number of strong children born to the wives of physically strong men.

The following are the demerits, of polygyny:

(i) It makes the family a center of quarrel and spoils family peace.

(ii) The status of women suffers a serious setback in a polygynous family due to the presence of several wives.

(iii) Children are not properly looked after in the polygynous family.

(iv) It lacks in better understanding, fellow feeling, sympathy, love and affection among the co wives.

(v) It is also disadvantageous from the economic point of view.

(vi) It snatches away the conjugal love and psychological satisfaction from women.

(vii) It causes jealousy and suspicion and family instability due to lack of proper understanding among spouses and offspring.

(b) Polyandry:

In polyandry type of marriage, one woman married to several men. The wife and the husbands may or may not be related to each other before marriage. The husbands may be related among themselves. If the husbands are all brothers, then this marriage is called fraternal polyandry. If the husbands are not related to each other and share the same wife, it is

called non-fraternal polyandry. Polyandry as a form of marriage is very much restricted and is confined to a few tribal communities, mostly along the foothills of the Himalayas. The Kota, the Khasa, the Toda, the Ladani Bota and the Khasi practice this type of marriage. There is evidence to establish the fact that some pre-Dravidian and Dravidian tribes practiced Polyandry.

Fraternal Polyandry (Adelphic):

The Todas of Nilgiris hills and the Khasa practices fraternal polyandry. The elder brother marries his wife and according to this practice of Adelphic, she becomes the wife of all the brothers. She is shared by all the brothers of a family for satisfaction of sexual urges. The minor brothers of the family become her husband after being major. But the elder brother becomes the father of all her children.

Non-Fraternal Polyandry (Non-Adelphic):

In this form of marriage, a woman marries many men who are not necessarily brothers. She satisfies their sexual desire. By turn, going from one husband to another. The husbands may either live in one place or in different places. During her life with one husband, that particular husband enjoys her exclusively for that particular period and others do not have their right at that time. The Nayar women practice non- fraternal polyandry and constitute a matriarchal family.

Polyandry is practiced due to several reasons. The imbalance in sex ratio, less number of females of marriageable age is another reason. The poor practices polyandry whereas the rich can afford to practise polygyny. Fraternal polyandry is often preferred to keep the family property undivided because, it does not allow the brothers to marry separate wives and live with them in separate

households. Higher Bride price may be considered as another cause of polyandry. When the husbands are unable to pay the bride price individually, they may prefer polyandry to monogamy.

Bigamy:

In Mysore, the Medara and Holiya tribes practise bigamy type of marriage wherein a male is allowed to marry two women at a time. The co-wives are related as sisters.

Preference & Prohibition in Tribal Marriage:

All societies have rule and restrictions about whom one may or may not marry. This is referred to as the system of prohibition or encouragement or preference of the choice of male in marriage. Madan & Majumdar write that "All over India, and in other parts of the world as well, we come across rules laying down prohibitions, preferences and prescriptions in deciding the form of marriage."

There are certain categories of relatives who come within the prohibitory degree of marital relationship. There are also some other relatives with whom sexual relationship is prohibited. "A Taboo on sexual relationship between closely related kin like parents and children and between siblings is universal.

An extension of this “nuclear prohibition” is found everywhere. Therefore, among several tribal communities we find the practice of marrying outside the family, clan, village etc. Violation of this restriction is seriously dealt with. The practice of marrying outside one’s own family clan, village or group is called as Exogamy. Among the Indian tribes we also find another peculiar practice of marrying within one’s own group. This marriage within one’s own group is known as Endogamy. The Victorian Anthropologist MacLennan had coined these two terms, which simply meant marrying in and marrying out.

(a) Family Exogamy:

Marriage outside the family.

(b) Clan exogamy:

Marriage outside the clan.

(c) Village Exogamy:

Marriage outside the village. The practice of clan exogamy is widely followed among the Indian tribals like Gond, the Baiga, the Ho, the Korwa, the Khasi, the Nagadsoon. The Munda tribe of Chhotanagpur region practise village exogamy.

Tracing the cause of Exogamy, Audrey Richards has pointed out that “in hunting and food gathering societies, food is difficult to obtain. Women and children are generally a burden in such societies, particularly those which rely more on hunting. This could have led to female infanticide, which in consequence, would lead to female scarcity. This must have led to marriage by capture, and the next step-since such capture had to be affected from outside the tribe to exogamy. Thus, food scarcity may be, historically speaking a probable cause of exogamy.”

Endogamy:

Majumdar and Madan say that the practice of marrying within one’s own tribe or very rarely the clan is called endogamy.

Thus, mainly, we find two types of endogamies:

(a) Clan endogamy—Marriage within the clan.

(b) Tribe endogamy — Marriage within the tribe.

The Todas of Nigiri Hills have two main clans such as Tartharol and the Teivaliol. These clans are endogamous groups, but their subdivisions and sibs practise exogamy. Likewise, the Bhils have two endogamous groups such as-the Uyale Bhil and the Mele Bhil. Most of the tribes are clan exogamous but phratry and tribe endogamous. However, now-a-days, some sophisticated tribes in India like the Gond, the Bhil and the Santhal have broken down the barriers of endogamy and have started marrying with the lower castes, for their incorporation into the Hindu castes.

A number of causes may be given in support of the practice of endogamy:

(a) Universal fear of the stronger, unknown and the novel- Generally the tribals are afraid of the neighbour's witchcraft and sorcery. The Korwa tribe practices endogamy particularly on account of that reason.

(b) Territorial and Linguistic Factors-Territorial and linguistic factors "impose limits on the communication of thoughts and persons (Spouses) between various groups."

(c) Desire to preserve the socio-cultural identity-Each tribal group possesses its own distinctive socio-cultural identity, sharing enough thought and action pattern. Which they want to preserve through the practice of endogamy.

Preferential Marriages:

In certain cases, there is a prescription expressed for establishing martial ties with a particular kin or preferences designed to promote inter-familiar cordiality by making certain linkages imperative. Such marriages are known as preferential marriages.

The tribes in India practise the following types of preferential marriages: (a) Cousin marriage.

(i) Cross cousin marriage.

(ii) Parallel cousin marriage.

(b) Levirate

(i) Junior Levirate.

(ii) Senior Levirate.

(c) Sororate.

Cousin Marriage:

The Gond, the Kharia, the Oraon, the Khasi, and the Kadar practice cousin marriage. **The cousin marriages can be sub- divided into:**

(i) Cross-cousin marriage and

(ii) parallel cousin marriage.

The marriage between mother's brother's (Maternal uncle's) children and father's sister's (paternal aunt's) children is called cross cousin marriage. Majumdar and Madan hold that "cross-cousin marriage as a form of exogamy, the only form of exogamy under dual organization, is often explained to be a device for avoiding payment of a high bride price and also for maintaining property in the household".

Cross Cousin marriage is found among different tribes in southern India. The Gonds of Madhya Pradesh practice cross-cousin marriage and call it; 'dudhlautawa' or the 'return of milk'. This is called so because the bride price paid by the husband for his wife comes back to his own family through the marriage of his daughter with the son of his wife's brother. Marrying one's father's brother's child or mother's sister's child is called a parallel cousin marriage. The main purpose of preferential mating, according to Levi-Strauss, is to strengthen the solidarity of a tribal group.

Levirate:

Sometimes, preferential marriages also aim at solidifying the inter-family unity. If a man dies, his wife is inherited by the brother of the deceased husband. This practice of being actual or potential mates to one's husband's brother is called levirate. The custom of Levirate is found among several tribes like Santal, Ho, Saora, Bhuinya, Munda etc. Marriage of the widow with the deceased

husband's elder brother is called senior Levirate. But when she married the younger brother of the dead husband, it was called junior Levirate.

Levirate as a form of marriage is useful for tribal society. First of all, it allows widow remarriage. Secondly it provides the widow with social security within the same family. Thirdly it also provides social security to the offspring of the widow which is not possible in other types of widow remarriage. Fourthly it strengthens the solidarity between inter-family unity.

Sororate:

The practice of being actual or potential mates to one's wife's sisters is called sororate. Majumdar and Madan hold that "when several sisters are simultaneously or potentially, the spouses of the same man the practice is called sororate. The death of a spouse is compensated by supplying a new spouse, generally a younger brother of the deceased ". The custom of Sororate is found among the tribal communities where the practice of bride-price is prevalent. Sororate also recognizes marriage as a tie between two families and lays emphasis on the acceptance of inter- familial obligations.

Positive sanction in Tribal Marriage:

The following types of marriage in the tribal societies are accorded positive sanction: (a) Tribe endogamy.

(b) Clan exogamy.

(c) Preferential Mating.

The tribe exogamy, clan endogamy (incest) are looked down upon, pre-marital or post-marital sexual relationship is not uncommon among tribal societies in India Indulgences in this kind of sexual activities is possible even without the displeasure of the society because pre-marital chastity is not stressed in marriages. The tribes living in the central India do not view pre-marital relationship seriously unless that leads to pregnancy. If it results in pregnancy, the male partner is compelled to marry the pregnant girl.

In the Bastar district of Madhya Pradesh, the Muria Gonds allow the bachelors and Maiden to sleep in a common dormitory. They are free to indulge in pairing off in the dormitory. The Orans, the Khaddi, and the Hos indulge in pairing off activities on important festivals like Magha-parab, among the Konyak Nagas a girl may indulge in pre-marital sex till she becomes a mother. The Khas allow pre- marital sex but strictly prohibit any extra-marital sexual relationship for the wives.

Religion:

Tribal religion is based on oral traditions. The tribes express their beliefs in everyday language. Their rituals are aimed at solving day to day problems of life. Objects of worship are things of nature such as trees, rivers, mountain, sun, moon and earth. Rituals are mostly performed collectively and transmitted orally.

Tribal World view is grounded in the natural events and life-experiences. Their cosmology is socially effective i.e. existential, but un-interpretative.

Faith in supernatural is structured in a tribal society. According to the 1961 census of India, it would appear that about 89 per cent of the tribals claimed to profess Hinduism and 5 per cent had converted to Christianity. Most of the tribals in India follow some or other form of Hinduism. It is mainly due to the contacts the tribals had with their Hindu neighbors. Christianity was introduced among the tribal groups during the British rule.

Almost all the tribal religions across India believe in the existence of spiritual powers. The most important problem of life is to deal with these powers to ensure individual and collective well-being. The solution for this is to seek conciliation and communion with the more definite and potent personal spirits and to deal with the more indefinite and impersonal forces by way of control, expulsion or avoidance through appropriate rites, ceremonies, spells and taboos.

Religion of a tribe is simple. Religious beliefs and behavior are not treated as something apart from other kinds of beliefs and behavior. Religion pervades all aspects of their life. Tribal life and society cannot be fully understood without understanding their religion.

Tribal Religion in a state of simplicity:

Religion of a tribe is simple insofar as it is expressed in everyday language and experienced in everyday life. Every tribal religious system consists of three essential elements. Firstly, they believe in the existence of a superhuman world which refers to the belief system of tribals. Secondly, they form a human relationship to the superhuman world which refers to their value system. Thirdly for establishing a relationship they practice various rites and rituals which refer to their action system.

The tribals believe the superhuman world as the real world. They communicate to this world through symbolic words called the ritual language.

Forms of ritual may vary from one tribe to another, but the basic ritual code of Mantra, Mudra, Dhvani, and Vyavahariki is applicable to all cultures.

Mantras are simple words of everyday language used by tribes in the performance of their rites and rituals.

Mudras are various kinds of hand gestures and bodily positions representing specific feelings and esoteric actions. In tribal dance the movement of steps, interlocking of hands and other hand gestures have both aesthetic and ritualistic significance.

Dhvani is the third component of ritual language. The sound of musical instrument guides the dance Mudra. Certain forms of sound have special significance.

In course of the performance of a ritual what follows in the form of prescriptions or instructions, thoughts, methods and behaviour is the vyavahariki code.

Religion and Magic

We can see the effect of religion and magic in any primitive and modern, developed and undeveloped society and culture. There is no visible society and culture in which the presence of these two aspects (religion and magic) is not targeted. Even in today's advanced religious societies, the presence of magical actions is targeted. In both rural and urban areas of India, there are tricks and sorcery along with religious activities. Similarly, in primitive cultures there is a predominance of magic rituals, we can see many religious rituals being performed in their original form.

Therefore, it would not be untrue to say that both religion and magic have equal importance in the field of day-to-day social life and both prove helpful in nurturing different aspects of life. Nevertheless, here we have to accept that in societies and cultures in which science is relatively underdeveloped, the predominance of religion and magic is more than in developed societies and cultures. Science and scientific approaches tend to explain phenomena logically and thus reduce the need for non-rational methods.

The beliefs and beliefs generated by this experience can develop in two different directions. If a person accepts his incapacity and bows before these supernatural powers and starts worshiping them and considering himself dependent on him and surrenders to him, then the feeling which is created in it is called religion. On the contrary, when these supernatural forces are tried to be subdued and controlled then it is called magic.

Magic: Conceptual Analysis

Magic is such a process of practical actions by which supernatural powers are controlled with the help of some special mystical and secret techniques and methods and attempts are made to fulfil the desired cosmic desires.

In order to make magic clearer, it is necessary to note their following characteristics:

1. Magic is such a process of practical activities, under which various types of mystical and occult techniques and methods, such as mantras etc. are used.

2. By the use of these techniques and methods, the desired worldly objectives are fulfilled.

3. The fulfilment of these specific goals is considered to be coercive, because under it efforts are made to gain control over supernatural powers.

4. In this, an attempt is made to please the supernatural powers in a mystical way.

5. Religious prayers and praise are also sometimes used in magic. In the field of Hindu religion, it is believed that if a person chants Mahamrityunjaya by a virtuous person, then for some time victory over death can be achieved. Along with this, it is also believed that if one chants Mahamrityunjaya in reverse:

If one does or gets it done in the name of one's enemy, the death of his enemy is inevitable. If a person with this thinking does the reverse chanting of Maha Mrityunjay in the context of causing harm to his enemy, then this act will be considered as a magical act and not as a religious act, because such accomplishment can be achieved only by following some specific techniques and methods. not supernatural power by the grace or grace of. This would prove that religion and magic may be found in combination. element involved in magic.

1. Use of certain techniques and methods

Some special techniques and methods are used in magic activities. With the help of these techniques and methods, an attempt is made to influence the events that occur automatically. With the help of these, an attempt is made to liquefy the gods or supernatural powers. The users of specific techniques and methods have the belief that if certain programs are implemented in a subtle way, then certain results will definitely come out. Thus, the legal application is based on a preconceived notion of an overall regularity of cause and effect. The most important of the specific techniques and methods is the technique "Mantra". Mantras are words that are different from common words and are often kept secret. It is used only by those who do magic.

2. With the use of Mantras of some specific physical equipment

Some specific physical devices are necessarily used in the magic action. In this, essentially physical materials, such as soil, rice, mustard, skull, flower, wax, knife, hair, fingernail, betel, soap, thread, rope, flower, bean and other gross physical and atomic substances are used. It is believed that the supernatural cannot be forced to act according to will without the use of material factors.

3. Mystical Behavior

The performance of mystical behavior is considered essential for the achievement of the goal in the magic action of. The magician is seen performing many types of rituals to gain control over the supernatural power. In this context, he expresses a variety of emotional expressions in a dramatic manner. Often his body posture is situated in a specific posture. His state of mind is somewhat surprising and strange. Sometimes his form looks very frightening.

4. Special costumes, costumes and ornaments

There is a great need to wear special clothes and costumes in the magic action. Magicians generally use various colors to make their personality attractive. They are often required to wear coloured clothes like black, garrick and red etc. To make the body attractive, they are in addition to different types of coloured clothes. R's ornaments are also used. In the ears, they also use an ornament called Kundal and Karna Shobhan, and a string etc. in their hands. Often, they also wear gems around the neck. Kapir Jadar embellishes the hair itself by weaving it in various forms. In the fingers of the hands, they also often use rings made of materials.

5. Prohibited Behavior

Certain diets and types of behaviour are prohibited on the days when magical rituals are performed. Not only this, but in those days, it is considered necessary to lead a different type of life from the normal life. If the desired effect is not achieved by the magic action, then it is often thought that the magician must have violated some prohibited practices in relation to its failure.

Similarities Between Religion and Magic

1. In both religion and magic, there is complete faith in getting the help of supernatural power. Both of them are prayed to get the help of this power.

2. Both of them are inspired by the mystery of creation.

3. The core of both is contained in subjectivity.

4. Both often serve a practical purpose.

5. The sides of rituals and rituals are equally visible in both.

6. Both are characterized by collective action.

7. There is a certain less to be done to do both.

8. In both, the need for a "virtuous" person is felt. In the field of religion, the role of a virtuous person is seen as a priest, while in the field of magic the role of a 'virtuous' is seen as a magician.

9. In both religion and magic, certain mantras are kept secret.

10. In both, certain foods and types of behavior are prohibited.

11. It is believed in both that the combined effect of chants and actions brings closer to the accomplishment of the desired.

12. The reason for the failure of the intended goal in both is attributed to either an error in the word order of the mantras or the actions performed with them, or the violation of the mandatory prohibitions by it.

Differences in Religion and Magic

Not only that religion and magic are characterized by many similarities, but it is also true that religion and magic are completely different and separate from each other on the basis of their fundamental elements. This difference can be explained as follows:

RELIGION	**MAGIC**

1. Religion is related to living energy. 2. Full faith in supernatural power under this it occurs. He is worshiped and worshiped and prayers are also offered to get his grace and help. 3. supernatural for the desired attainment in it Persuasion is done with power. In this, the sense of charity and service are always present. 4. There is a feeling of devotion in the person towards religion. He dedicates himself, body, mind and wealth to him. He forgets his existence and takes refuge by saying Vahi-trahi. In this context, devotees worship flowers, fruits and water for the ultimate truth. 5. It is filled with reverent humble words. Being overwhelmed by the Supreme Being and seeking His grace is true righteousness. The difference between a religious person and Service is always present. 6. In religion, an attempt is made to remain confined to the cold. 7. The relation of sheep and shepherd is found in religion. 8. There is a personal emotional attachment between the religion and its followers. 9. Human weakness is accepted in religion	1. Magic is related to non-living power. 2. Full faith in supernatural power under this Despite this, it is not prayed for, but it is kept under control on the basis of the power of the mantra. 3. supernatural for the desired attainment in it Force is used by force. 4. In this, there is a greater sense of one's own power and the feeling of possessing one’s control over the supernatural power is found. There is a complete lack of dedication in it. 5. It is filled with obedient words. 6. In this, to be free from supernatural power effort is made. 7. The relation of buyer and seller is found in magic. 8. Impersonal and non-emotional relationship is found between magic and its followers 9. Magic is based on this belief of humans.

10. More general purposes are often served in religion. In this, efforts are made to achieve the socially accepted objectives. 11.Religious acts are considered sacred. 12. Religious rituals and practices become institutionalized. 13. Religion works to bind its followers to the thread of unity in church and group. The feeling of 'we' is found in his followers. 14.Religion Ethics is relative. It is filled with altruism and public welfare and benevolent spirit. Sociability and morality are the soul of religion. 15. Religious activities usually represent their church group. 16. Religion is generally oriented towards the non-experiential, unknown world. Although it can also be related to this cosmic world, yet there is always a reference to the extraterrestrial world. remains existing.	10. Common in Jad Special Often Personal efforts are made to achieve the objectives 11. Magical acts are considered impure. 12. Magical acts are not institutionalized. 13. Magic is completely incapable of binding its followers in the thread of unity. 14.Magic ethics is absolute. It is dominated by stubbornness and arrogance. It is antisocial and immoral in nature. 15. Magical activities represent only one magic performer. 16. It is generally lacking in magic, because it is concerned only with the known experiential world.

Types of magic

The different types of magic spells that have been accepted by different groups are

1. **Homeopathic or imitative magic**

This type of magic means the same effect is produced i.e. the same key. This means when there is a kind of magic that the result is homogeneous. Its doers believe that his actions will have an effect and thus his desires will be achieved.

Eg.: In Kollari society, whenever a young lover goes home to meet his beloved at night, he takes some soil from the crematorium with him, which he puts on his girlfriend's cross. Its purpose is that at the time of their secret meeting, the beloved's mother should keep sleeping in her sleep and due to them there should be no obstacle to the lover-girlfriend. Here is the exemplary resemblance of the crematorium's girlfriend to the parents' deep sleep.

The tribes in Chotanagpur understand that the thunder and thunder associated with electricity is the direct cause of rain. Therefore, to bring rain, they climb the mountain and push the big rocks down. They try to bring rain from the rumble produced by rolling down these rocks. There is an exemplary similarity between the thunder of stones and the thunder of lightning.

2. Natural Magic

The basic premise of mundane magic is that if an object comes into contact with a person, it is understood that the object in contact always affects the person in contact, even if it is physically distant from that person. Why not?

For example, some people believe that a person's hair or nails are related to that person's body, so even if they are cut off from his body, it remains in relation to his body. If any personal property of a person is lost or taken away or removed from him, he continues to have relation with that property. Thus, what happens in one part will affect the other part equally. Changes in one part result in similar changes in other parts as well. Although this relationship may not be as effective as the natural causal relationship, it is believed that by performing a magical action on it, it can have a greater effect on its holder. The magician can use that item to his advantage. Hair or nails can be destroyed without any effect on separation from the body. But if any other person takes his hair or nails and injures or harms his holder by doing magic acts on him, then his power increases. That is, the original holder thereof may be equally liable to injury or harm.

3. Frequency Magic

The implication of frequency magic is that when events occur simultaneously or follow a specific sequence, it is understood that simultaneous events will always occur on the same pattern.

4. Sympathetic Magic

Fraser used the term sympathetic magic for both imitative magic and temporal magic. Fraser says that the objects on which magic actions are performed are target oriented. Due to contact or similarity, sensory feelings are stimulated, due to which the action performed on those objects affects the target and the intended. That's why this magic is called sympathetic magic. This magic is not always positive, but sometimes rendering of certain works is prohibited in it.

5. "White" Magic and "Black" Magic Conjugation

White" type of magic is called beneficial magic. It is used for the benefit of an individual or a group. The special thing about this magic is that a magician It cannot be used to cause harm to the society.

“When the velocity of the wind became very strong, a hereditary wa-jab of the community chanted loudly……the words of the mantra were simple.” He ordered the wind to slow down, inactive……. ..he insisted that no harm could come to the village,

When the cholera epidemic spread in the "West Town" of China's Yunnan province, people could protect themselves by participating in many religious-magical acts. It is clear from the above description that white magic is always accepted by the society, and it benefits the whole society.

Black magic is always evil in principle. By its use the magician harms the members of the society. The magic done to make someone sick is "black" magic. This magic is sometimes socially acceptable and sometimes unconstitutional according to the circumstances.

Under black magic, "saucer" (witchcraft) and "witchcraft" come. In Sausari, those actions and mantras come which according to the cultural belief, the magician is given his power for his power.

Kinship Degree:

Relatives can be divided into several categories depending on their proximity or distance. Father's son, sister-brother, and husband-wife relationships are examples of close, direct, and close relatives. Primary kin is the term for these people. There are eight primary kin groups, according to Dubey. Father-son, mother-daughter, father-daughter, mother-son, younger elder brothers, younger elder sisters, and sister- brother are the relationships they have.

There are also secondary kins to consider. They're cousins of cousins. In other words, they share a common ancestor. They are not our primary kin, but the primary kin of our primary kin, which makes them our secondary kin. For instance, secondary kin include the father's brother and the sister's husband. My primary kin is my father, and his primary kin is his brother. As a result, my secondary kin, or primary kin of primary kin, is my father's brother. In the same way, one's sister is the primary kin, but her husband is secondary.

There are tertiary kins as well. They are a person's primary kin's secondary kin or secondary kin's primary kin. Because brother-in-law is one's secondary kin and his wife is brother-in-primary law's kin, the wife of a brother-in-law, known as sarhaj in Hindi, is tertiary kin. Because one's brother is one's primary kin and his brother-in-law is one's secondary kin, one's brother's brother-in-law is one's tertiary kin.

The study of the kinship system encompasses not only the description of various types of kin and the basis for their classification, but also the analysis of different kinds of behaviour patterns. Every relationship has its own set of behaviours. A son shows respect for his father, whereas a husband shows love for his wife. A brother's affectionate behavior toward his sister is admirable. There are a few usages that control how different kin behave. Kinship usages are a type of usage that occurs when two people are related. The following are some of these examples:

Avoidance: Avoidance is used in some form or another in all societies. It implies that the two kins should keep their distance. To put it another way, they should keep their distance from one another. They should avoid not only sexual relationships but also seeing each other's faces in some instances. As a result, a father-in-law should keep his distance from his daughter-in-law. The Hindu family's purdah system exemplifies how to avoid conflict. For the use of avoidance, various explanations have been offered. Radcliff Brown and G.P. Murdock both offered functionalist explanations. They believe that avoiding conflict between relatives helps to prevent further, more serious conflict. The third theory is that avoidances are a type of institutionalized neurotic symptom, as explained by Freud.

Joking Relationship: This is the polar opposite of avoidance. It allows one family member to tease or mock the other. Devar-and Bhabhi's JijaSali's relationship is a joke. It's possible that the joking will devolve into an exchange of insults and sexist references.

Teknonymy: Taylor coined the term "teknonymy" from a Greek word. Kin is referred to indirectly through other kin in this usage. Between two kins, a kin acts as a point of reference. As a result, a wife in a Hindu family does not say her husband's name. Her son or daughter dials his number. She calls him Guddu's or Tunnu's father.

Avunculate: In the matriarchal system, this kinship usage is unique. It elevates the maternal uncle in the eyes of his nephews and nieces. He owes them special responsibilities in addition to his father's. He has the first claim to their allegiance. Among the male relatives, he is the first.

Amitate: Amitate is a term used to describe when a special role is assigned to a father's sister. The mother receives less respect than her father's sister.

Couvade: A queer term used by many primitive tribes, such as the Khasi and Toda. Whenever his wife gives birth to a child, the husband is forced to live as an invalid alongside his wife. He avoids physical labour and adheres to a sick diet. He follows the same rules as his wife when it comes to taboos. As a result, the husband and wife are included in this kinship usage.

Kinship:

Its Purposes: Kinship functions serve two primary purposes.

They begin by forming groups, which are special kin groups. As a result of marriage, each mother is assigned a husband and her children are assigned to him, forming a unique group of father, mother, and children that we refer to as "family."

The second major function of kinship usage is to regulate kinship roles, such as how one kinsman should act in the presence of another or what one kinsman owes to another. Kinship establishes rules for how people interact with each other. It establishes appropriate roles for father and daughter, brother and sister, son-in-law and mother-in-law, and fellow lineage members and clansmen. As a result, kinship acts as a social stabiliser and keeps the social system together.

It should be noted, however, that the rules governing a pair of kinsmen's relationship are integrative and group-oriented in nature.

UNIT-III

LONG QUESTIONS

1. Define Kinship and explain its importance in primitive and traditional societies. Discuss the role of kinship in social organization, economic cooperation, political authority, social control, marriage and inheritance.
2. Discuss the major types of kinship groups. Explain family, lineage, clan, phratry and moiety, and distinguish between consanguineous and affinal kinship with suitable examples.
3. ·Explain the meaning and functions of family in tribal society. Discuss the different forms of family on the basis of marriage, structure, residence, authority and descent.
4. Discuss the major theories concerning the origin of religion. Explain the evolutionary approach with special reference to E. B. Tylor, James Frazer, Herbert Spencer and R. R. Marett.
5. Explain the Functional Theory of Religion. Discuss the views of Émile Durkheim, Bronislaw Malinowski and A. R. Radcliffe-Brown regarding the social and psychological functions of religion.
6. Explain the relationship between Magic and Religion in primitive societies. Discuss their meaning, functions and importance in dealing with uncertainty, danger, illness and other situations beyond ordinary human control.

UNIT-IV

Tribe: Meaning and chief Characteristics

Concept of Tribe

The word “Tribe” is taken from the Latin word “Tribus" which means “one third”. The word originally referred to one of the three territorial groups which united to make Rome. India is known as a Melting pot of tribes and races. After Africa India has the second largest concentration of tribal population within the world. Approximately there are about 698 Scheduled Tribes that constitute 8.5% of India's population as of the 2001 census. Tribal populations have some specific characteristics which are different from other tribes. They are simple people with unique customs, traditions and practices. They lived a life of isolation, or you can say that geographical isolation. In India aboriginal tribes have lived for 1000 of years in forests and hilly areas without any communication with various centres of civilization. Now, there is a need to integrate tribes into the mainstream of the society as a rightful member with respect.

Definition of Tribe:

There are no exact definition or the criteria for considering a tribe as a human group. However, researchers defined it in various forms at different times. Sometimes they called “Tribe” as “aboriginal” or “depressed classes” or “Adivasis”.

Normally, ‘tribe’ may be a group of individuals during a primitive or barbarous stage of development acknowledging the authority of a chief and typically regarding them as having the same ancestor.

While **D.N. Majumdar** defines tribe as “a social group with territorial affiliation, endogamous with no specialization of functions ruled by tribal officers hereditary or otherwise, united in language or dialect recognizing social distance with other tribes or castes”.

Definition:

D.N. Majumdar

A tribe can be understood as a social group having a common name, territory, language and cultural characteristics, along with a sense of unity among its members.

Gillin and Gillin

A tribe may be viewed as a group of local communities occupying a common geographical area and having a common culture.

Important Point

There is **no single definition of tribe** that perfectly describes every tribal community in India. Tribal communities differ considerably from one another in their economic conditions, languages, customs, level of urbanisation and interaction with wider society.

Following are the characteristics of Indian tribes: -

• They have a definite geographical and social area.

• Lives in a Hilly or Forest area.

• An integrated social organization on the basis of primarily blood relationships. • Cultural homogeneity is the main characteristic of tribal communities. • They have a common Dialect with a shared folklore.

• Hierarchy among men and groups is absent.

• Instrument of social bonds among tribes is Kinship.

• Absence or Lack of strong, complex, formal organization.

• Communitarian basis of land holding.

• Segmentary character.

• Little value on additional accumulation on the use of capital and on market trading • Lack of distinction between forms as well as substance of religion. • A distinct psychological view towards enjoying life.

Geographical location of tribes:

In India Tribal Community identified in five major language families, i.e. Andamanese, Austro Asiatic, Dravidian, and Tibeto-Burman. All of the Tribals of a particular language family live in a particular or distinct geographical setting. For example, the Central Dravidian family, the Indo Aryan Family and Austro-Asiatic (Munda) family of South Orissa. The North-Dravidian, Indo Aryan and Austro-Asiatic language families of Jharkhand. Tribal peoples in India live in the following five territories.

1. The Himalayan belt that includes Nagaland, Assam, Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh, Mizoram, Manipur, Tripura, Himachal Pradesh and hills of Uttar Pradesh.

2. Central India that includes Orissa, Bihar, West Bengal and Madhya-Pradesh. Approximately 55% of the tribal population among all of India lives in this belt.

3. Western India belt includes Rajasthan, Gujrat, Maharashtra, Goa, Dadra & Nagar Haveli.
4. The Dravidian region of India includes Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra-Pradesh, Kerala.
5. Islands of Andaman, Nicobar and Lakshadweep.

Tribal Policies in India: Tribal Policies in India is based on Isolation, Assimilation and Integration and last Democratic Decentralization of Tribal People. The Government of India has adopted a policy of integration of tribals with the mainstream aiming at developing a creative adjustment between the tribes and non tribes leading to a responsible partnership.

The constitution has committed the nation to two courses of action in respect of scheduled tribes:

i.Giving protection to their distinctive way of life

ii.Protecting them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation and discrimination and bringing them at par with the rest of the nation so that they may be integrated with the national life.

Thus by the Constitution Order 1950 issued by the President of India in exercise of powers conferred by Clause9 (i) of Article 342 of the Constitution of India 255 tribes in 17 states were declared to be scheduled tribes. Besides enjoying the rights that all citizens and minorities have the member of the Scheduled Tribes have been provided with special safeguards as follows:

Some Protective Safeguards are:

• Educational Safeguards-Article 15(4) and 29

• Safeguards for employment -Articles 16(4), 320(4) and 333

• Economic safeguards -Article 19

• Abolition of bonded labour -Article 23

• Protection from social injustice and all forms of exploitation -Article 46

Some Political Safeguards are:

• Reservation of seats for ST in Lok Sabha and Assemblies-Article 330,332,164 • Appointment of Minister in charge of Tribal welfare

• Special provisions in respect of Nagaland, Assam and Manipur -Articles-371(A),371(B) and 371

Some Developmental Safeguards are:

• Promoting the educational and economic interests of the Scheduled Tribes-Articles 46

Grants from Central Government to the states for welfare of Scheduled Tribes and raising the level of administration of Scheduled Areas-Article 75

Following the reorganization of states, the list of STs was modified by the Scheduled Castes and Tribes List (Modification) order, 1956 on the recommendations of the Backward Classes Commission. In the revised list 414 tribes were declared STs. Since the revision of the list in 1956 there have been several proposals for fresh inclusions and deletion from the lists of the SC and STs.

Current Scenario of STs as per Census 2011: The total population of the Scheduled Tribes within the country stands at 84326240 which constitute 8.2 percent of the total population (the 2011 census). They are covering all the states except Haryana and Punjab and also over all the union territories except Chandigarh out of their total population within the country. The current data released by the Census of India shows that the child sex-ratio among STs in

the country has declined rapidly than in other categories of the population between 2001 and 2011.

For the Protection, Socio-economic and Political development of scheduled tribes, the constitution of India says:

Social Development:

1. Equality before Law (Article 14)

2. The state must make special provisions for the advancement of any socially and educationally backward classes of citizens or for the Scheduled Tribes and others.

3. Equality of opportunity for all citizens in matters relating to employment or appointment to any office under the state (Article 16).

4. For reservation in appointment, posts in favor of any backward class citizens which in the opinion of the state are not adequately represented in the services under the state (Article 16[4]), in matters of promotion to the scheduled tribe (Article 16 [4A]).

5. A National Commission for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes to investigate, monitor and evaluate all matters relating to the constitutional safeguards provided for the STs (Article 338).

6. Appointment of a commission to report on the administration of the Scheduled Areas and the Welfare of the Scheduled Tribes in states (Article 339).

7. Appointed by the Govt. of India, the commission has to investigate the conditions of socially and educationally backward classes and to make recommendations to remove their difficulties which they faced during their work (Article 340).

Economic Development:

1. The state promotes with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections of the people, scheduled tribes in particular and protects them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation (Article 46).

The claims of the members of the ST in the appointments to services and posts in connection with the affairs of the union or of a state to be taken into consideration consistent with the maintenance of efficiency of administration (Article 335)

Political Development:

1. Through the Fifth Schedule, the administration and control of Scheduled Areas and the Scheduled Tribes in any state except Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram by ensuring submission of Annual Report by the Governors to the President of India regarding the Administration of the Scheduled Areas and setting up of a Tribal Advisory Council to advice on such matters pertaining to the Welfare and advancement of Scheduled Tribes (Article 244[1]).

2. Special provisions through the Sixth Schedule for the administration of Tribal Areas in the states of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram by designating certain tribal areas as

Autonomous Districts and Autonomous Regions by constituting District Councils, Autonomous Councils and Regional Councils (Article 244[2]).

3. Reservation of seats for the Scheduled Tribes in the House of the people (Article 330).

4. Reservation of seats for the Scheduled Tribes in the Legislative Assemblies of the states (Art.332)

5. Reservation of seats for the Scheduled Tribes in every Panchayat (Article 243D).

Extension of the 73rd and 74th Amendments of the constitution to the Scheduled Areas through the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996 to ensure effective participation of the tribal peple within the process of designing and deciding. The concept of tribe or tribal social formation was referred by most anthropologists as a stage destined to maneuver toward a far better or more developed stage towards the 'Mainstream' society by means of history within their own political space, promising to vary whatever existed for long. A question arises that there has been a big change within the lives of the tribal population from the past years after independence. But the question is whether the communities of the tribals in India benefited from the current development model? Tribal population continues to occupy rock bottom economic strata, its areas of habitation are the least developed in infrastructure and every one aspect of development. Keeping this state of affairs of tribals in mind; we'd like to question the very definition of the tribes as given by the colonial anthropologists which remains continued to explain tribes as a particular categorization of pre- literate cultures, covering a good range of sorts of social organization and levels of techno- economic development. Many Sociologists specializing on the topic have pointed out; that what's missing within the process of conceptualization is the acknowledgement of history and of a posh economics. Hence, tribal ways of life, its cultures, its social structures and economics were treated as inferior as compared to the so called advanced or educated western culture-based societies.

BHIL

● The word Bhil is derived from “Veel”, which means “bow” in the Dravidian language.

● The Bhil tribe is called “Dhanush Purush of India” because they are known to be excellent archers coupled with deep knowledge about their local geography.

● Bhils are a group of tribal Indians scattered throughout India from Gujarat in the west to Tripura in the Far East.

● As of 2013, they were the largest tribal group in India with the majority living in the states of Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Chhattisgarh.

● Bhils have a rich and unique culture. The Bhilala subdivision is known for its Pithora painting.

● Ghoomar is a traditional folk dance of the Bhil tribe.

o Ghoomar is the symbol of femininity.

o The young women take art in this dance and declare that they are stepping into women’s shoes.

● Traditionally, experts in guerrilla warfare, most of them today are farmers and agricultural laborers. They are also skilled sculptors.

● Bhil women wear traditional saris while men are dressed in long frock and pyjamas. The woman put on heavy ornaments made of silver, brass along with rosaries of beads and silver coins and earing.

SANTHAL

● Santhal is the third largest scheduled tribe community in the country after Gond and Bhil.

● The word 'Santhal' is derived from two words; 'santha' meaning calm and peaceful and 'ala' meaning man.

● **Background:**

o in the past, the Santhals were leading a nomadic life.

o Gradually they came to settle down in the Chota Nagpur plateau.

o Towards the end of the 18th century, they migrated to the Santhal Parganas of Bihar and then they came to Odisha.

● **Location (Major):** Jharkhand, Odisha and West Bengal.

● **Major Occupation:** Cultivation, Industrial Labour, Mining, Quarrying ● **Religion:**

o Autonomous Tribal Religion

o They are nature worshipers and pay their obeisance at Jaher (sacred groves) irrespective of the positions they hold.

● **Language:**

o Santhals speak Santhali which has its own script called 'OL chiki' invented by Pandit Raghunath Murmu.

o Santhali in OL-Chiki script has been included in the Eighth Schedule to the Constitution.

● **Society:**

o The common types of marriages permitted in their society are by negotiation, by elopement, by intrusion and by service.

o Junior livirate, sororate and remarriage of widows, widowers and divorcees are also permitted in their society.

● **Architecture:**

o Santhal houses called 'Olah' are distinct and can be identified from a distance.

o They are large, neat and attractive with multi-coloured paintings on the outside walls.

o The bottom of the wall is painted with black soil, the middle portion with white and the upper portion with red.

● **Artforms:** Of late, the Santhal's Phuta Katcha pattern saree and dress, sold through e commerce sites, are widely accepted in the community.

● **Major Festivals & Rituals:**

o Erok-sim : For sowing seeds

o Saharai : Cattle worship

o Magha-sim : Dancing and merrymaking

o Baha : Ritual for first fruit of Mahua and ceremonial hunting

GOND

● Gonds are one of the largest tribal groups in the world.

● They are mostly live in Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Jharkhand, Karnataka, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal and Odisha.

● Gonds are subdivided into four tribes:

▪ Raj Gonds

▪ Madia Gonds

▪ Dhruve Gonds

▪ Khatulwar Gonds

● Their staple food is two kinds of millet: kodo and kutki

● Gonds believe that earth, water and air are ruled by Gods.

● They majorly speak Gondi which is an unwritten language of the Dravidian family. ● It has been notified as a Scheduled Tribe.

Acculturation

The exchange of cultural features owing to continuous first-hand contact between two groups is known as acculturation. The development of a mixed language that helps different cultures in contact to communicate known as pidgin is a process of acculturation.

For example, in Tamil Nadu owing to the trade routes used by the Arabs a new dialect Arabi-Tamil came into being, which is a mixture of Arabic and Tamil (Pandian 1995). Likewise, Nagamese is a language which is a mixture of Naga and Assamese words. Such acculturation can take place in other aspects of cultural life, like for example the influence of Christianity in Nagaland when seen in terms of marriage ceremonies, where many of the marriages take place in the Church with the bride wearing the white bridal gown, rather than the traditional marriage ceremonies in their traditional Naga attires yet wear some insignia like a headband of their own culture. Thus, owing to acculturation Christianity as a religion and its preachings and way of life was adopted and made a part of the local traditions of the Nagas.

Assimilation

Assimilation is the process by which a person or a group inculcates much of the habits, manners and ways, and starts resembling an existing group. Herein, we can consider the case of the Brahmins of Assam who had originally migrated from Kanauj and other eastern and northern regions during the Ahom rule as an example. The Brahmins of Assam, speak the Assamese language and their life cycle rituals like marriage follow the Assamese customs and dress. They are non-vegetarian and mostly eat fish, whereas in other parts of India, Brahmins are vegetarian. In the context of the present globalized world, Indians living abroad and also in India are seen to have assimilated many of the cultures of the Western world. Food is one such space where a lot of variations are seen, such as the coming up of the fast-food corners comprising burgers, pizza etc. which is now a part of the Indian diet. In the first instance, the Brahmins from outside became a part of the local tradition of Assam, whereas in the second case the foreign food was made a part of the Indian tradition.

PROBLEMS AND WELFARE OF INDIAN TRIBES

Tribal people are the most vulnerable section of human society. This is because of their:

- Resource-based livelihoods,
- Location of their homes in vulnerable environments
- Poverty
- Marginality.

They face numerous problems, ranging from the decades-old issues of land alienation and debt bondage to the recently emerging issues of environmental change and degradation.

LAND ALIENATION

Land for Tribals

Land is a vital natural resource for human life. Land, for most people including tribals, is not merely an economic resource (source of livelihood), but also a symbol of social status and identity (individual identity and identity of community inhabitation, e.g., Nagas, Khonds, Savaras, Konda Reddis), security and self- reliance. However, landholding patterns in tribal areas today reflect a form of unequal distribution and/or alienation of land.

Land Ownership

Traditionally, tribals had a three-tier land ownership and control system:

- Community land
- Individual land
- Clan land

Every community had well-defined boundaries and traditional administration systems based on customary laws. There were definite rules, generally controlled by the village council, on who could cultivate what land and in which season. They performed many social activities and rituals related to land and agriculture in their society.

Land Alienation

Since land is a marketable commodity, its alienation or transfer happens. Land alienation means transfer of title and possession from one person to another. In the context of tribals it means the tribal community losing ownership and control of tribal land.

Forms of land alienation

As alienation of land happens both within and outside the tribal community, we can classify land alienation into two types. These are:

- internal transfer of land (by tribals)
- land alienation by external forces.

Internal Transfer of Land

In such alienation, land is transferred from a tribal landowner to another tribal. This internal transfer of land or mortgage is necessitated by the need for money for medical care, education, etc. It results in internal disparity (inequalities in its distribution and control), which is one form of land alienation within the community (High-level Committee 2014). However, this is a minor issue when compared with land alienation by external forces.

Land Alienation by External Forces

Land alienation by external forces is of two types:

1) Alienation of land by non-tribals. Migrants and outsiders encroach on tribal lands, resulting in tribal people losing control over their lands.

2) Alienation of land by development projects in the tribal region.

Majority of land alienation happens by external forces and is a major problem for the scheduled tribes of India.

Alienation of Land by Non-tribals

In spite of constitutional safeguards and legislative measures for protection of tribal land, like the State Scheduled Area Regulations and Tenancy laws, land alienation by non-tribals in connivance with the instruments of the state continues. According to Kamal K. Misra (2002in "Study of alienation of tribal lands in Schedule V Areas"of Andhra Pradesh, undivided Madhya Pradesh and Odisha), tribal-to-tribal transfer of land accounted for 14.04%, while tribal-to-non-tribal transfer was 85.95%. There were eight methods adopted by land transferees in the study villages:

1) sale

2) mortgage

3) benami transfer

4) forcible occupation

5) oral transfer of possession

6) marital alliance

7) buying land in the name of concubines

8) other fraudulent means.

Methods of land alienation by non-tribals

The following are important ways land is alienated by non-tribals.

a) Leasing and mortgaging

Land sustains the livelihood of tribals, who have very few other assets. Tribals need to borrow money from moneylenders on occasions such as:

● marriages and death rituals,

● medical emergencies involving family members

● continuous crop failure due to the dependence on seasonal monsoon and poor irrigation

To meet their needs, the poor and helpless tribals are forced to borrow money by mortgaging their land to local moneylenders at high-interest rates. When the tribal people fail to pay back the borrowed money, the land is transferred to non-tribal creditors.

b) Encroachment

Outsiders befriend local leaders and bribe them to get ownership of land. The new entrants, who are economically well off, slowly occupy the tribal land and establish themselves by procuring patta by networking with government officials. This becomes a significant threat to the tribal people, who are illiterate and unaware of modern land record management systems in the country.

c) Marital alliance

Outsiders make use of marital alliances or concubine age with tribal women to buy land in the name of their tribal wives or concubines. They thus escape the law and grab tribal land. This method is more prevalent in areas that are closer to non-tribal areas.

d) Fictitious adoption of the non-tribal by the tribal family

Outsiders adopted fictitiously on paper by tribals enjoy the tribal land and escape the provisions of land transfer regulations.

e) Benami transfer

Transfer of land through *benami* is another important method of land alienation by outsiders.

Alienation of Land by Development Projects

The High-Level Committee report (2014) considers development projects as one of the main causes of tribal land alienation. Because of high demand for land for development projects, the state acquires land in the name of "public purpose" without a compulsory "land for land" provision for rehabilitation. The report further says that land alienation is also due to:

● collusion of revenue officials,

● incorrect interpretation of laws,

● manipulation of records and permissions accorded to alienate land.

DEBT-BONDAGE

Indebtedness or debt-bondage refers to an obligation to pay money to another party. Debt-bondage among tribals is a significant problem, often leading to situations of bonded labor.

History of Debt-bondage

The origin of the problem of debt-bondage can be traced back to the time when the monetary economy in tribal areas was introduced by non-tribal outsiders. The outsiders penetrated tribal areas during the British colonial times. The monetary economy gradually substituted the barter economy of the tribal areas. Originally the tribes had a self-contained economy and were masters of large tracts of lands. During British times, non-tribal people who entered these areas found the tribal people easy prey for their schemes of exploitation. They started lending money to the tribal people against the security of their lands. They charged exorbitant rates of interest (100 to 300 percent).

The tribals were illiterate but honest. They became victims of dishonest and unscrupulous methods of money lenders. Among the tribals, debt became a continual process that would pass on from father to son to grandson. It is generally said that tribals once in debt were always in debt. Debt bondage made the tribals bonded labourers of moneylenders on their own lands (Verma 2017).

Methods Followed by Non-tribal People for Lending Money to Tribal People

There are four such methods:

1) Short-term loan: The repayment of a loan, which is at an excessive rate of interest, is made in kind by way of agricultural produce. Such a loan is mainly for clothes and food grains.

2) Medium-term loan: This loan is repayable with compound interest at yearly or half-yearly periods. Such a loan is given against the security of land.

3) Long-term loan: This loan is given for a fixed number of years against the lease of land. This land is to be cultivated by the tribal debtor for delivering products to the moneylender, until the repayment of the entire loan.

4) Usufructuary mortgage: Here loan is given on mortgage of land at compound interest. The moneylender remains in possession of the land and enjoys the produce from the land. The tribal person works as labour on his/ her own land for the benefit of the unscrupulous moneylender. In case of default, the money lender takes possession of the land.

Causes of Debt-bondage

There are many causes of debt-bondage. Debt- bondage is attributed mainly to the following:
1) Extreme poverty,

2) Loopholes in the money lending laws,

3) Lack of awareness among tribals about sources of institutional finances (such as banks and co-operative societies),

4) Indifferent attitudes of officials (government and banks),

5) Absence of any regulatory control against private moneylenders,

6) Weak public delivery system of essential commodities and agricultural inputs, and 7) Lack of employment opportunities for tribals.

Constitutional and Legal Provisions

Special provisions under the Fifth Schedule of the Constitution empower the Governor of a State having scheduled areas to make the following regulations:

1) to regulate the business of money lending

2) to provide protection against exploitation of Scheduled Tribes by moneylenders.

Some examples are the Andhra Pradesh (Scheduled Areas) Money Lenders Regulation, 1960; and the Andhra Pradesh (Scheduled Tribes) Debt Relief Regulation, 1960, 1970.

Problems in Implementation of Legislations

Though some legislations or regulations were made, there is no adequate machinery for enforcement of such legislations or regulations. Further, licenses for regulation of the business of money lending have not been issued.

Alternative/Remedial Measures

As remedial measures, alternative credit facilities have been provided for short- term and long-term loans. Procedures are simplified for speedy payment of loans. LAMPS (Large Area Multi-Purpose Co-operative Societies) and PACS (Primary Agriculture Co-operative Societies) have been started to meet loan and other consumer requirements in tribal areas. However, these societies have failed because of financial constraints and lack of administrative will.

EDUCATION

In this section, you will learn about the existing provisions in the Constitution of India and government policy on education for tribals, and the actual status of education among them.

Constitutional Mandate on Education to STs

The Constitution of India provides specific provisions under the following articles for promotion of education among the backward and weaker sections of the society.

Article 15(4) empowers the State to make any special provision for advancement of socially and educationally backward classes of citizens or for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes.

Article 41 empowers the State to make effective provision for securing the right to work, education and public assistance in [certain] cases of unemployment, old age, sickness and disablement…

Article 45 empowers the State to provide, within a period of ten years from the commencement of Constitution, free and compulsory education for all children until they complete the age of fourteen years.

Article 46 empowers the state to promote educational and economic interests of SCs, STs and other weaker sections. "The State shall promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the weaker sections of the people, and, in particular, of the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and shall protect them from social injustice and all forms of exploitation."

Thus, the provisions pertaining to education existed but mainly in the Directive Principles of State Policy. However, the Right to Education has now been made a Fundamental Right under Article 21Aofthe Constitution (Eighty-sixth Amendment) Act, 2002.

Article 21A: Under article 21A, the Government of India enacted a legislation called the "Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009". It is simply known as the Right to Education Act (or RTE). "The State shall provide free and compulsory education to all children of the age of six to fourteen years in such manner as the State may, by law, determine."

Despite such provisions, there is wide gap in terms of percentage of literacy between tribals and general population. For instance, according to 2011 Census, total percentage of literacy among general population is 73, whereas among scheduled tribes it is 59.

Main Causes of Low Literacy in Tribal Areas

The following are the main causes of low literacy among tribal people, according to Verma (2017): 1) Poverty of the parents,

2) Medium of instruction,

3) Contents of education,

4) Inadequate infrastructure and supporting services,

5) Absenteeism of teachers,

6) Lack of education policy, and

7) Socio-cultural factors.

The Poverty of the Parents

For poor parents, children's education is a luxury, which they cannot afford. Grown-up children assist parents in earning a livelihood; they look after younger children. Absence of childcare centres (creches, balwadis) in tribal areas also deprives children from poor families from education.

The Medium of Instruction

Since tribal children are taught in a language which is not their mother tongue and is new to them, there are high dropouts from schools and the literacy is low. Article 350A of the

Constitution empowers the state to provide adequate facilities for instruction in the mother-tongue at the primary stage of education, to children belonging to linguistic minority groups. Though the tribals are entitled to instruction in their mother tongue, they have not been provided such facility, not even at the primary school stage.

Contents of Education

The general curriculum or contents of education is extended to tribal areas. Most of the curriculum is not relevant to the tribal people as it does not consider their needs and aspirations.

Inadequate Infrastructure and Supporting Services

Tribals face the problem of inadequacy of educational institutions, boarding and lodging facilities. Supporting services, such as incentives in terms of scholarships and book banks are insignificant to attract the children.

Absenteeism of Teachers

Teachers are absent for days because there is little or no supervision over them and they are not dedicated to the education of tribals. So, the children often drop out of school.

Lack of Education Policy

Lack of administrative policy regarding the educational institutions in tribal areas affects the education of tribals.

Socio-cultural Factors

The general education system does not respect tribal culture and traditions; instead, it presents a negative picture about tribal culture.

Suggestions to Improve Tribal Education

The following are suggested to improve tribal education:

1) Making education value-based,

2) Improving infrastructure and supporting services,

3) Creating non-formal and vocational education centres,

4) Teaching in mother tongue at the primary stage,

5) Setting up sports training centres (Verma 2017), and

6) Providing economic assistance to needy children and families.

Making Education Value-based

Provide job-oriented education and make proper arrangements for vocational education. Include traditional local skills and crafts in education. Teach elementary civics to familiarize children with their rights and duties.

Improving Infrastructure and Supporting Services

Opening of educational institutions and construction of school buildings must get priority under NREGS. Provide residential (hostel) facilities to all (who walk more than 4 km) to attend school. Establish childcare centres (creches, balwadis) in tribal areas and provide suitable nutritional programmes in such centres.

Creating non-formal and Vocational Education Centres

Set up non-formal and vocational training centers to meet local needs (projects in tribal areas).

Providing economic Assistance to Needy Children and Families

Provide temporary economic help to low-income families to replace the loss of labour of their children.

Teaching in Mother Tongue at the Primary Stage

Teaching in mother tongue makes children follow and understand instructions quickly and encourages them to continue their schooling.

Setting up Sports Training Centres

Sports training centres will help tribal children promote their talents.

HEALTH

Health status

The status of health among tribals is in general very poor. This is predominantly so among the Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs). This is mainly because of their relatively isolated and remote living, unaffected by the process of development. Tribals are highly vulnerable to diseases. Their misery is increased by poverty, illiteracy, ignorance of causes of diseases, difficult geographical terrains and harsh climatic zones, lack of safe drinking water, poor sanitation and certain blind beliefs.

Cultural Factors in Health and Medicine

Culture plays an important role in tribal health and medicine. Attitudes, beliefs and values affect the willingness of tribal people to take voluntary action concerning their health and that of other members of their family. Non-biological human factors (social, cultural and behavioural factors) are essential to determine many diseases. How people live, what they eat, believe, value, and what resources they have at their end, are significant determinants of their individual and collective health. For instance, see the case below.

Case: Health-seeking Behaviour Among Birhors in Madhya Pradesh

According to Pandey et al. (1999), the Regional Medical Research Centre for Tribals (now National *Institute* of *Research* in *Tribal Health* (NIRTH)), Jabalpur, did a study among the Birhors in Madhya Pradesh during 1993-94.

The Birhor is a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group. Their population was diminishing overtime. It was found that their demographic status was associated with their health status, which in turn, was related to their health-seeking behaviour. Their health-seeking expression was associated with beliefs, customs and practices, since the majority of their population was

illiterate, impoverished and lacking access to modern health facilities. According to their belief system, sickness was caused due to the evil spirit or displeasure of God. They relied on *gunia*, the tribal doctor (Pandey et al.1999).

Antenatal and post-natal care Among Birhors

As per Pandey et al. (1999), pregnant women were prohibited from eating fish because it was believed that just as fish swings upwards and downwards in water, the child at the time of delivery may also go upwards and downwards.

Delivery was conducted in an open space outside the house in a nearby hut (*tada*) made especially for delivery, irrespective of the season. It was believed that their god becomes annoyed if the delivery takes place inside the main house.

The umbilical cord was cut (by mother) with the help of a bamboo strip (40% of cases), new blades (15% of cases), knife (6% of cases), shells (9% of cases), and stone (3% of cases). They preferred to cut the navel cord with a bamboo strip. Because they believed, if a knife or blade cuts it, the affected place is likely to be swollen. They also opined that if the navel cord is cut with the help of an iron- made instrument, it may inject poison into the body of the child.

There was little awareness about immunization of the mother during pregnancy and of the child after delivery (9.6%). For example, a woman aged 31 years narrated the following: "I have four children. I did not take any injections or tablets during pregnancies. As I learnt from my mother in-law, those are harmful to the foetus and may even lead to abortion or stillbirth" (Pandey et al. 1999).

People were aware of free medicines available at the Primary Health Centre (PHC) but claimed that the doctor did not treat them properly. Under these circumstances, the Birhors preferred to go to local healers. They were superstitious and lacked faith in modern medicine. Some practices prevailing in the tribe related to antenatal care, natal and post-natal care (including immunization) were likely associated with the high mortality (particularly infant mortality) (Pandey et al. 1999).

Modern Healthcare

Compared to others, tribals have relatively less access to modern health care facilities. Most of them experience unsatisfactory services of health care providers. Nevertheless, the importance of modern medicine is being realized due to various reasons. These include changing conditions in tribal areas and growing awareness about advanced health care. People are seeking modern health care and medicine for specific health issues, for which they have no other effective remedies.

ISSUES OF ENVIRONMENTAL DEGRADATION

Environmental degradation has been a significant concern for our country for the past few decades. Proper management of the environment and natural resources is essential, as our survival and wellbeing depend on them. Degradation of the environment or resource base may lead to decreased production. For instance, reduced fertility of soil may result in lower yields, and deteriorated quality of water may affect the quality and quantity of fish in the natural water bodies as well as our health. Such problems are a matter of great concern

particularly to the tribals, as they have a direct impact on their livelihood, food security, health and well-being.

Forms and Causes of Environmental Degradation

Environmental degradation takes different forms, such as:

● forest degradation

● desertification

● land degradation

● water pollution.

Environmental degradation is caused mostly by anthropogenic (human-made) activities, rather than natural phenomena. The causes include:

● overpopulation

● deforestation

● unsustainable agricultural practices

● over-consumption

● pollution of air and water maldistribution of wealth

Significant consequences of environmental degradation and destruction of resources include increased poverty, overcrowding, famine, weather extremes and species loss.

Forest Degradation

Degradation of the forests is an important form of environmental degradation. Some of the degrading effects are:

● It causes loss of diversity in species and natural resources and leads to man–animal conflicts in tribal areas.

● It affects the forest ecosystem and tribal economy, for instance, loss of forest products and livelihoods to the forest-dependent tribal people.

● Certain diseases of wild fauna, which were once limited to forest areas, are now affecting our health and life, because of forest degradation. Millions of people are now getting affected by many such zoonotic diseases. For example, Ebola and COVID-19 are such

zoonotic disease-causing viruses, which have emerged as a grave risk to public health. In other words, loss of forests is considered to lead to zoonotic diseases, which affect human society.

UNIT-IV

LONG QUESTIONS

1. Define Tribe and discuss the chief characteristics of tribal society. Explain the social, cultural, political and economic features that distinguish tribal communities.
2. Discuss the socio-economic life of tribal communities. Explain their traditional occupations, economic activities, resource use, cooperation and relationship with the natural environment.
3. Discuss the characteristics and different forms of tribal family and marriage. Explain monogamy, polygyny, polyandry, nuclear, joint and extended families, along with patrilocal, matrilocal, patriarchal and matrilineal arrangements.
4. Discuss the major problems faced by tribal communities in India. Examine issues relating to land, forests, displacement, poverty, education, health, exploitation, cultural change and socio-economic development.
5. Explain the tribal policies of Segregation, Assimilation and Integration. Discuss the meaning, objectives, advantages and limitations of each approach in the context of tribal development.